



BARBADOS NATIONAL REGISTRY

Annual cardiovascular disease report 2025

Cardiovascular disease events and mortality in Barbados, 2010-2025

Published 29 November 2026

The University of the West Indies | Cave Hill Campus

PUBLICATION INFORMATION

About this report

Cardiovascular disease events and mortality in Barbados, 2010-2025

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This report provides an annual overview of cardiovascular disease events and mortality in Barbados. It presents results on heart attacks and strokes, with selected sex and age summaries, to support government, hospitals, clinics, public-health teams, researchers and other partners.

The results come from quality-controlled and approved BNR data releases. They should be read alongside the definitions, coverage notes and uncertainty information in this report. The report and its public data are available from the BNR Information Hub.

SUGGESTED CITATION

Howitt C, Campbell J, Hambleton I for the Barbados National Registry. Annual cardiovascular disease report 2025: cardiovascular disease events and mortality in Barbados, 2010-2025. The University of the West Indies, Cave Hill Campus, Bridgetown, Barbados; 29 November 2026.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

The Barbados National Registry acknowledges the clinical, hospital, registry, data-management and public-health teams whose work supports this report. Definitions, ascertainment rules, mortality classifications, uncertainty measures, data availability and disclosure controls are described in the online BNR Methods manual.

PUBLICATION DETAILS

Report	Annual cardiovascular disease report 2025
Reporting period	2010-2025
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How to read this report

A short guide to the information used in this report

The report presents several related views of cardiovascular disease. They answer different questions and should not be treated as interchangeable.

RESULT	WHAT IT COUNTS	HOW TO USE IT
Hospital-recorded events	Eligible Heart and Stroke episodes identified through hospital information. One person may contribute more than one separate event.	Describes serious events recognised through the hospital source.
Primary national event estimate	Hospital-recorded events plus the estimated contribution of additional death-certificate-only events using Clear and Likely evidence, after accounting for overlap.	The main BNR national event estimate.
Inclusive national event estimate	The Primary estimate expanded to include Possible death-certificate evidence.	Shows the effect of using the broader evidence definition.
Primary death count	Deaths with Clear or Likely cardiovascular evidence on the death certificate.	The main BNR mortality estimate.
Inclusive death count	Primary deaths plus deaths with Possible cardiovascular evidence.	Shows sensitivity to less-certain death-certificate evidence.
Age-standardised rate	A rate adjusted to a standard age structure.	Supports fairer comparisons between populations or periods.

Which BNR estimate should I use?

Use the Primary result as the main BNR estimate. The Inclusive result shows how the estimate changes when less-certain death-certificate evidence is included. Neither BNR mortality definition is equivalent to formally coded national underlying-cause-of-death statistics. See Section 4 | Methods.

Six other features to notice

CHARTS AND TABLES

Charts show the longer pattern over time; tables give exact results for the latest five complete years.

HOW COLOUR IS USED

Colour groups related measures and sections. **Teal** marks All CVD; **rust** marks Heart; **green** marks Stroke; **purple** marks women; and **blue** marks men. Colours support navigation and comparison.

UNCERTAINTY

Pale bands show uncertainty in the estimated DCO contribution. Whiskers show statistical 95% confidence intervals.

"WHAT THIS MEANS"

These notes highlight the main message from each result and any important context needed to interpret it.

PROTECTED VALUES

An asterisk marks a value withheld to protect confidentiality. It does not mean zero.

COMPANION PUBLICATIONS

Monthly updates provide the latest surveillance picture. Other BNR reports summarise key messages or explore selected topics in greater depth.

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2025 in brief

The latest complete year at a glance

CVD EVENTS

1,118

Primary national estimate

CVD EVENT RATE

229 per 100,000

Age-standardised | 95% CI 215-244

CVD DEATHS

368

Primary definition

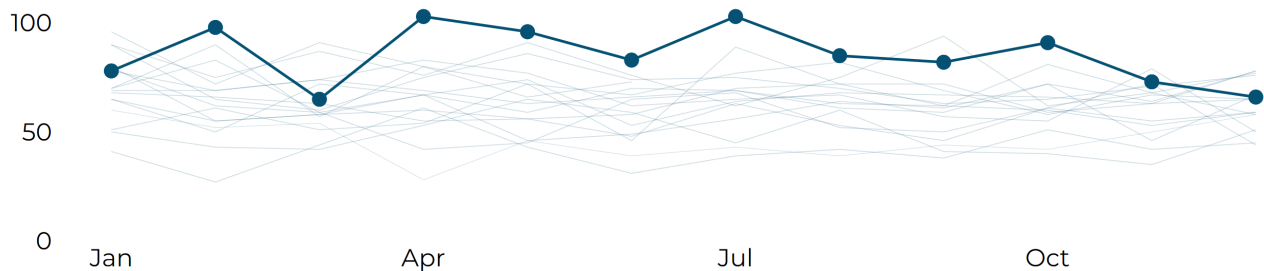
CVD MORTALITY RATE

76 per 100,000

Age-standardised | 95% CI 68-85

How the year unfolded

Monthly hospital-recorded CVD events. The dark line shows 2025; the lighter lines show earlier years. National estimates are updated annually after death records are added.



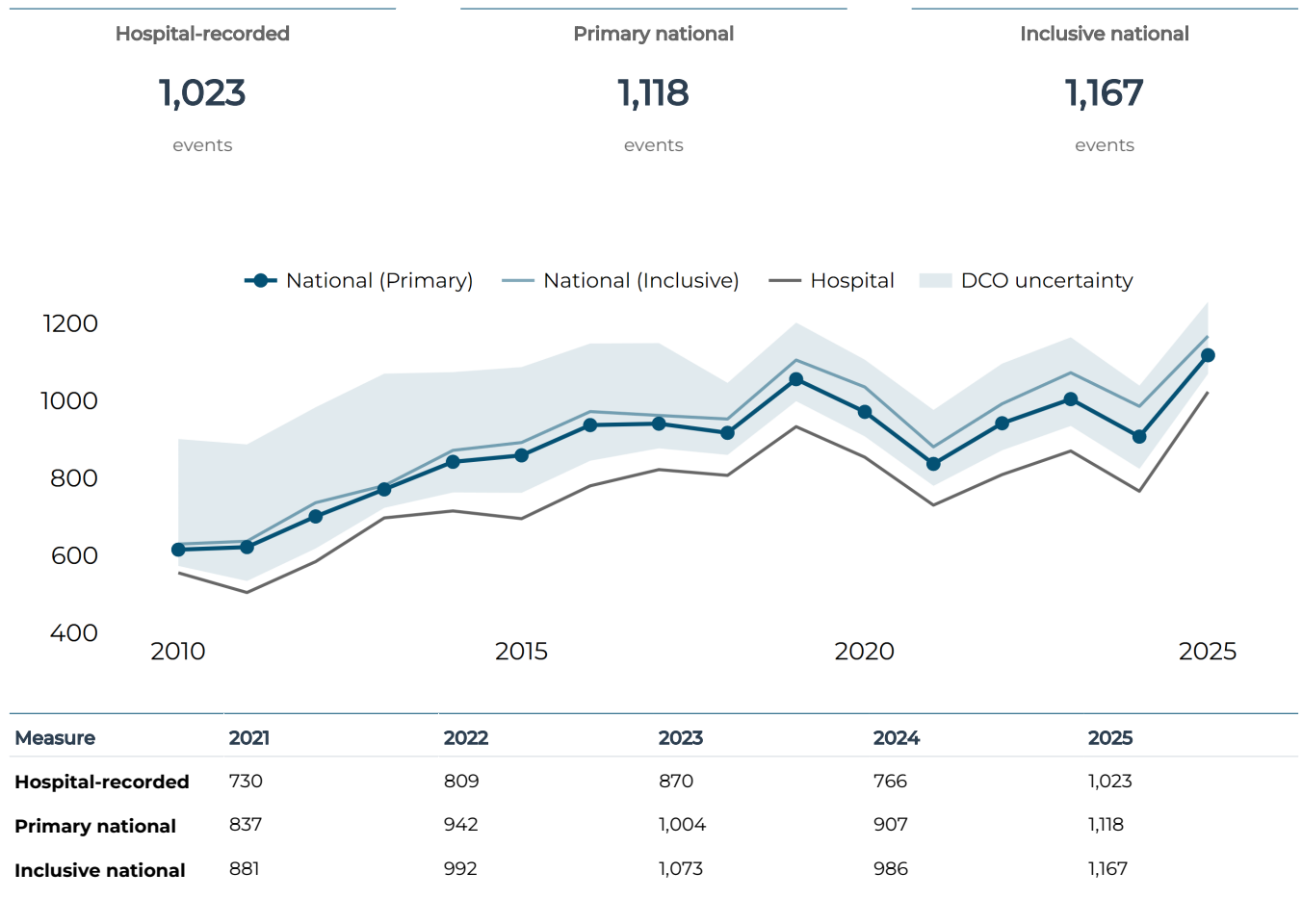
What stood out in 2025?

- 01** There were 1,021 hospital-recorded CVD events in 2025, about 27% above the published previous-five-year average of 805.8. The Primary national estimate was 1,115.8 events after adding the estimated contribution from events identified through death records.
- 02** The Primary national age-standardised CVD event rate was higher in men than women: 288.8 compared with 184.0 per 100,000.
- 03** Stroke accounted for 67.9% of hospital-recorded CVD events in 2025.
- 04** There were 368 Primary CVD deaths in 2025, about 7% below the previous-five-year mean of 394.2. The Inclusive definition counted 588 deaths, close to its recent five-year comparator, showing how strongly mortality totals depend on whether Possible deaths are included. Read more about our CVD death definitions in chapter 4|Methods.

1 | CVD events

CVD event counts

Hospital-recorded events and national estimates across the complete annual series.

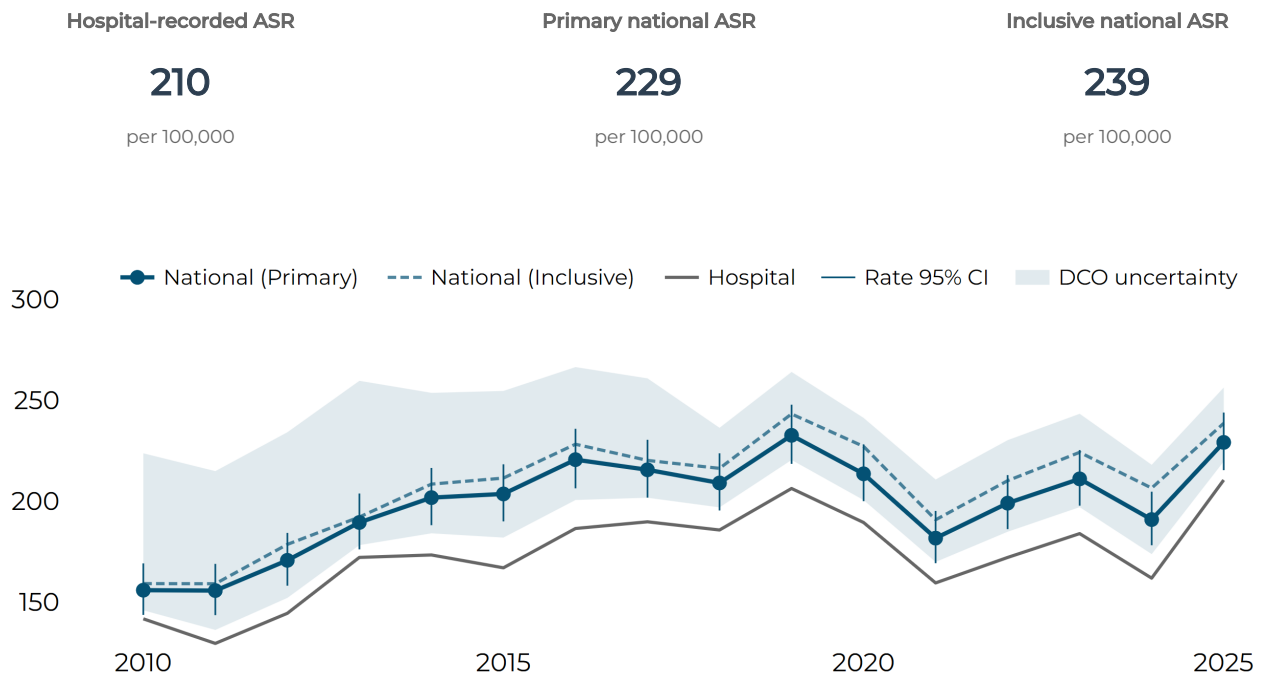


WHAT THIS MEANS

Hospital-recorded CVD events reached 1,021 in 2025: the highest annual count in the 2010 to 2025 series and 27% above the previous-five-year mean of 805.8. After including the estimated contribution from death-certificate-only events, the Primary national estimate was 1,115.8 and the Inclusive estimate was 1,165.4. All three measures point to an unusually high CVD event burden in 2025.

CVD event rates

Age-standardised rates per 100,000. Whiskers are 95% statistical confidence intervals.



Latest five complete years

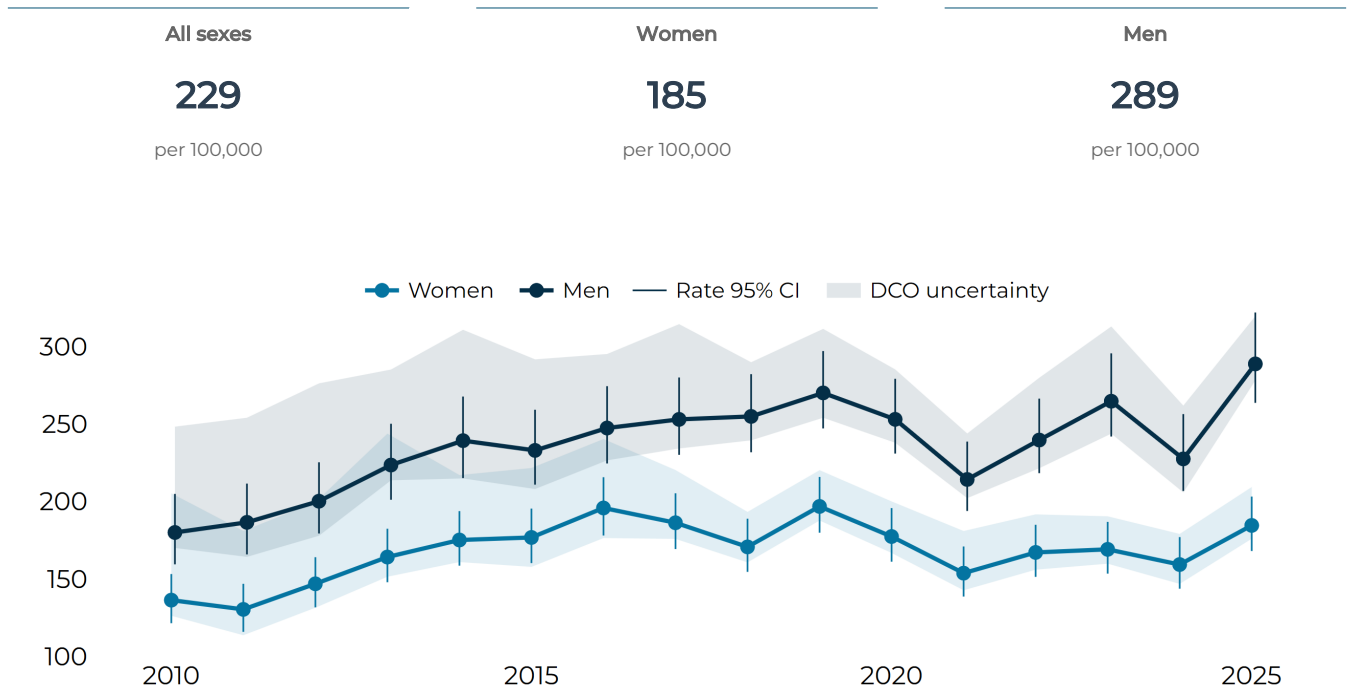
ASR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Hospital-recorded estimate	159.4	172.1	183.9	161.8	210.5
Hospital-recorded 95% CI	147.7 - 172.2	160.1 - 185.1	171.5 - 197.3	150.1 - 174.6	197.3 - 224.8
Primary national estimate	181.7	199.0	211.0	190.9	229.1
Primary national 95% CI	169.2 - 195.1	186.1 - 212.9	197.8 - 225.3	178.1 - 204.7	215.4 - 243.9
Inclusive national estimate	190.7	210.2	224.2	206.5	238.6
Inclusive national 95% CI	178.0 - 204.5	196.9 - 224.5	210.6 - 238.9	193.3 - 220.7	224.6 - 253.7

WHAT THIS MEANS

After allowing for differences in population age, the Primary national CVD event rate rose from 190.9 per 100,000 in 2024 to 228.8 in 2025, close to the series high of 232.6 in 2019. The 2025 hospital-recorded rate was 210.1 and the Inclusive national rate was 238.3. The three estimates give the same broad message of a high-rate year, while their separate confidence intervals and linkage ranges describe the uncertainty around the exact national level.

CVD events: women and men

Primary national age-standardised event rates per 100,000.



Latest five complete years

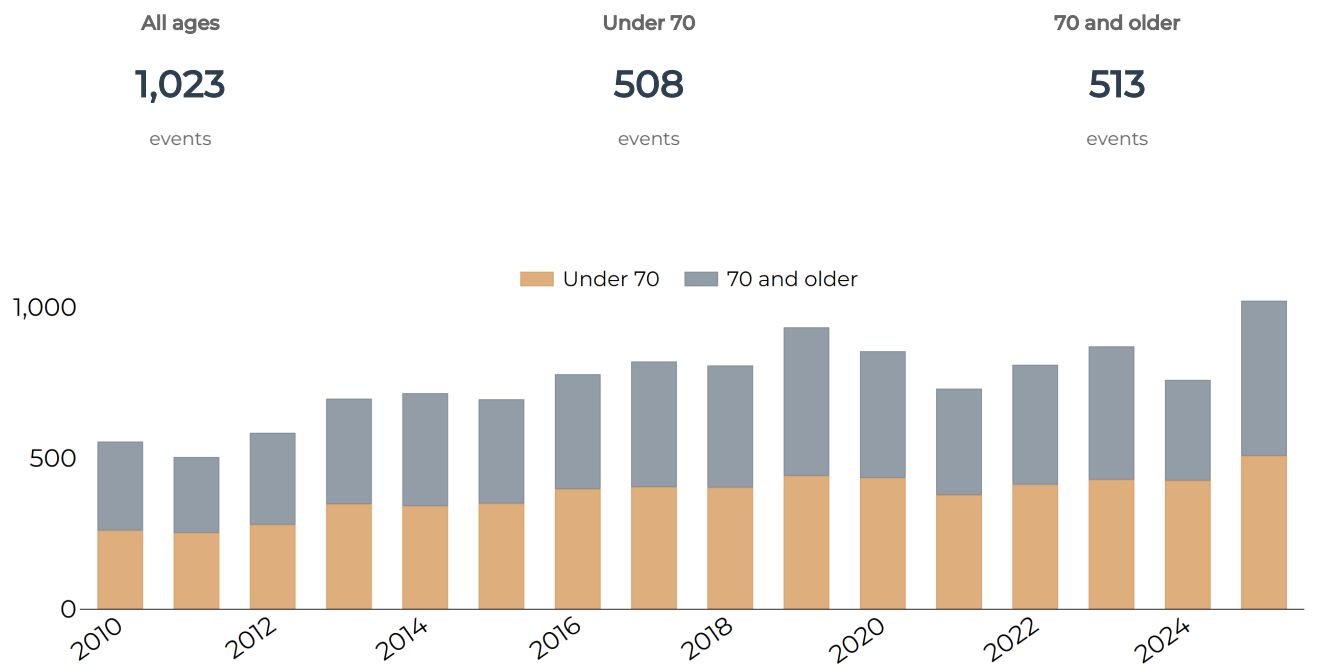
Primary ASR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
All sexes estimate	181.7	199.0	211.0	190.9	229.1
All sexes 95% CI	169.2 - 195.1	186.1 - 212.9	197.8 - 225.3	178.1 - 204.7	215.4 - 243.9
Women estimate	153.7	167.1	169.1	159.3	184.6
Women 95% CI	138.6 - 170.9	151.3 - 184.9	153.4 - 186.8	143.7 - 177.0	168.0 - 203.2
Men estimate	214.2	239.7	264.7	227.5	288.8
Men 95% CI	193.9 - 238.6	218.3 - 266.4	241.9 - 295.6	206.8 - 256.4	263.7 - 322.0

WHAT THIS MEANS

The 2025 Primary national age-standardised CVD event rate was 288.8 per 100,000 in men and 184.0 in women: about 57% higher in men. The male rate has been higher in every year of the 2010 to 2025 series, and the 2025 confidence intervals are clearly separated. This persistent difference is important for prevention and service planning; understanding its causes requires evidence on risk factors, diagnosis and access to care.

CVD events: age patterns

Hospital-recorded annual event counts by broad age group. These are composition counts, not age-specific rates.



Latest five complete years

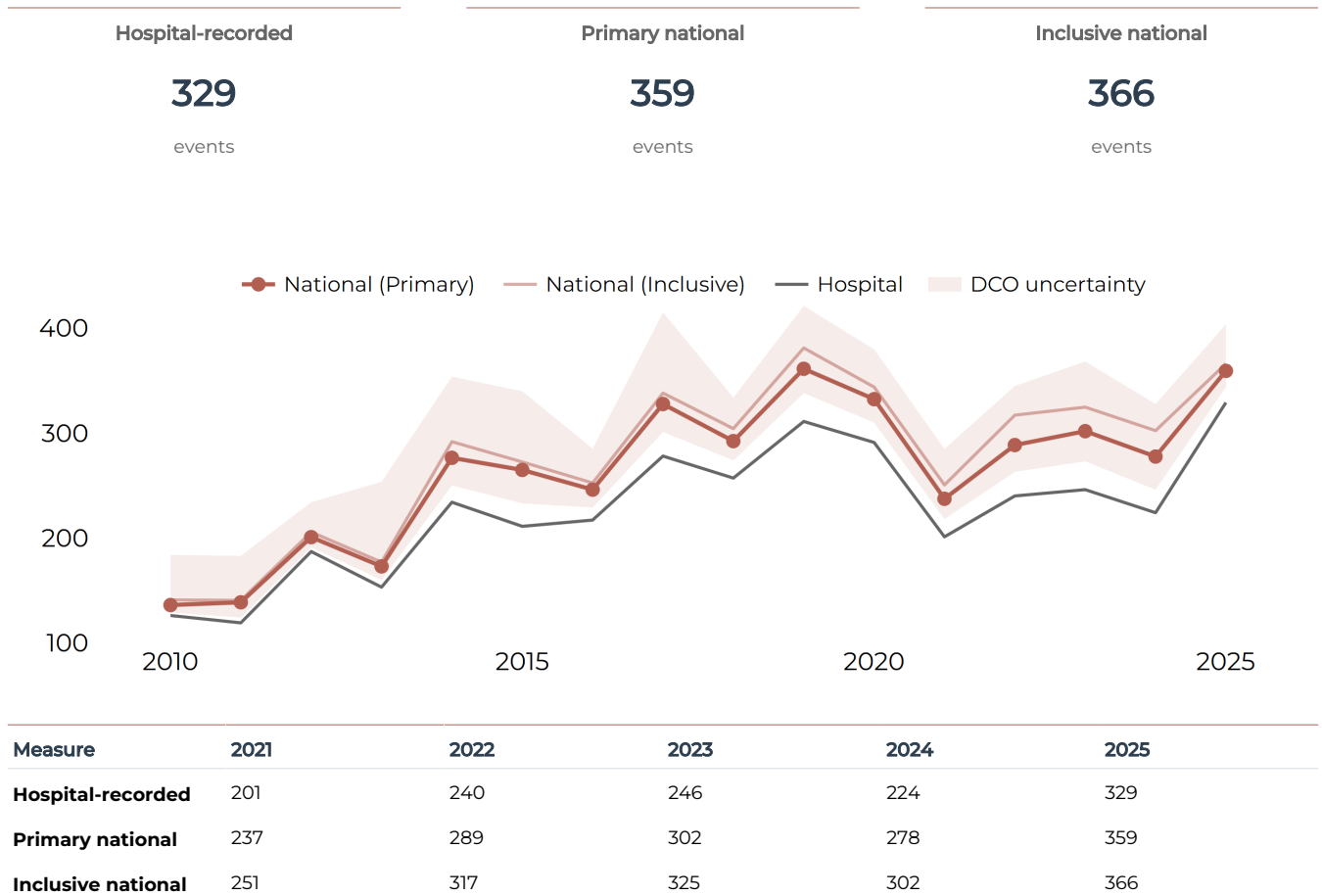
Hospital-recorded events	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
All ages	730	809	870	766	1,023
Under 70	378	413	429	426	508
70 and older	352	396	441	333	513

WHAT THIS MEANS

Hospital-recorded events were almost evenly divided by age in 2025: 508 among people under 70 and 511 among people aged 70 or older. Both groups were above their previous-five-year means of 416.2 and 388.2, so both contributed to the high overall count.

Heart event counts

Hospital-recorded events and national estimates across the complete annual series.

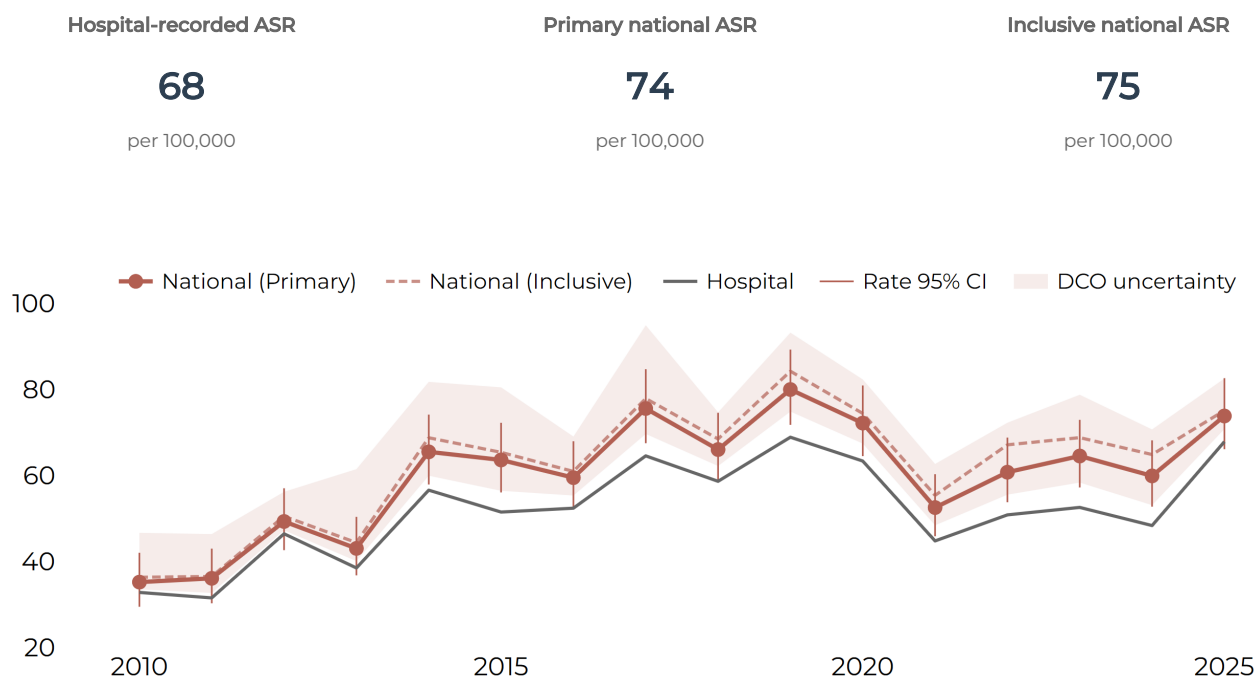


WHAT THIS MEANS

Hospital-recorded heart events reached 328 in 2025: the highest annual count in the 2010 to 2025 series and 36% above the previous-five-year mean of 240.4. The Primary national estimate was 358.2 and the Inclusive estimate was 365.1. The closeness of the two national estimates strengthens the conclusion that 2025 was an unusually high year for Heart events.

Heart event rates

Age-standardised rates per 100,000. Whiskers are 95% statistical confidence intervals.



Latest five complete years

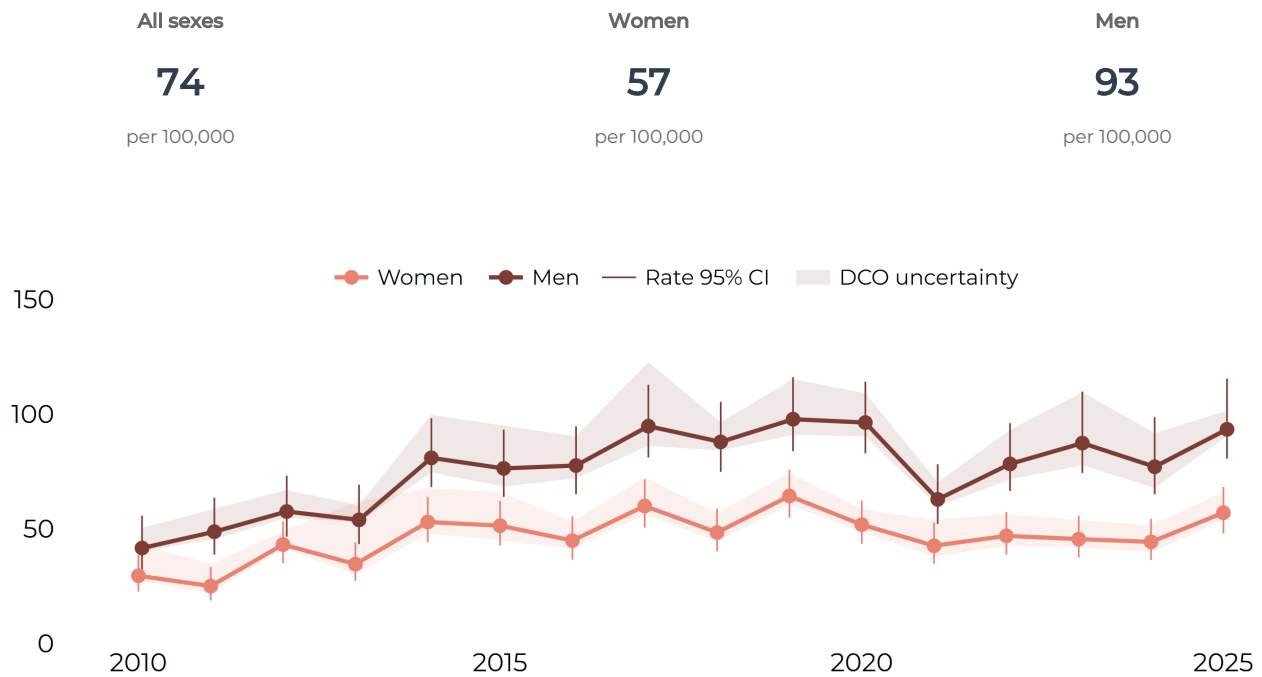
ASR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Hospital-recorded estimate	44.8	50.8	52.6	48.3	67.9
Hospital-recorded 95% CI	38.6 - 52.0	44.5 - 58.3	46.0 - 60.2	41.9 - 55.9	60.4 - 76.3
Primary national estimate	52.5	60.8	64.5	59.9	73.8
Primary national 95% CI	45.9 - 60.3	53.8 - 68.8	57.2 - 72.9	52.7 - 68.2	66.1 - 82.6
Inclusive national estimate	55.4	67.1	68.8	64.9	75.1
Inclusive national 95% CI	48.5 - 63.3	59.7 - 75.6	61.3 - 77.4	57.4 - 73.4	67.3 - 84.0

WHAT THIS MEANS

The 2025 Primary national heart event rate was 73.7 per 100,000, up from 59.9 in 2024 and the highest point estimate since 2019. The hospital-recorded rate was 67.7 and the Inclusive national rate was 74.9. The 2024 and 2025 confidence intervals overlap slightly, so further years will help show whether this increase is sustained.

Heart events: women and men

Primary national age-standardised event rates per 100,000.



Latest five complete years

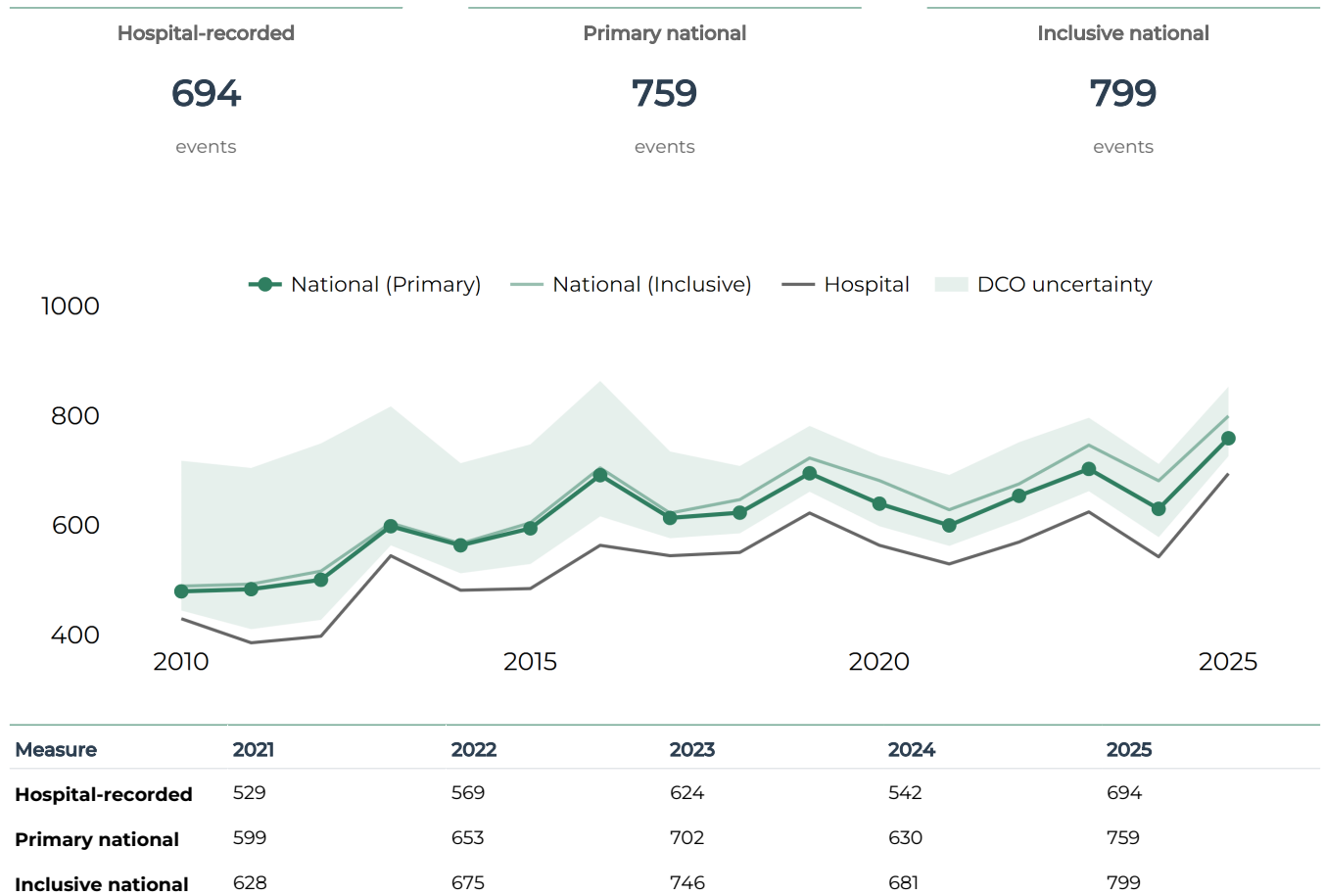
Primary ASR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
All sexes estimate	52.5	60.8	64.5	59.9	73.8
All sexes 95% CI	45.9 - 60.3	53.8 - 68.8	57.2 - 72.9	52.7 - 68.2	66.1 - 82.6
Women estimate	42.6	46.9	45.5	44.3	57.0
Women 95% CI	34.8 - 52.7	38.7 - 57.3	37.5 - 55.7	36.4 - 54.4	48.0 - 68.2
Men estimate	62.8	78.3	87.4	77.1	93.4
Men 95% CI	52.1 - 78.1	66.5 - 96.1	74.3 - 109.8	65.0 - 98.7	80.6 - 115.5

WHAT THIS MEANS

The 2025 Primary national heart event rate was 93.4 per 100,000 in men and 56.7 in women: about 65% higher in men. The male rate has been higher throughout the 2010 to 2025 series, and the 2025 confidence intervals are clearly separated. This persistent pattern is important for prevention and service planning, while its causes require further evidence.

Stroke event counts

Hospital-recorded events and national estimates across the complete annual series.

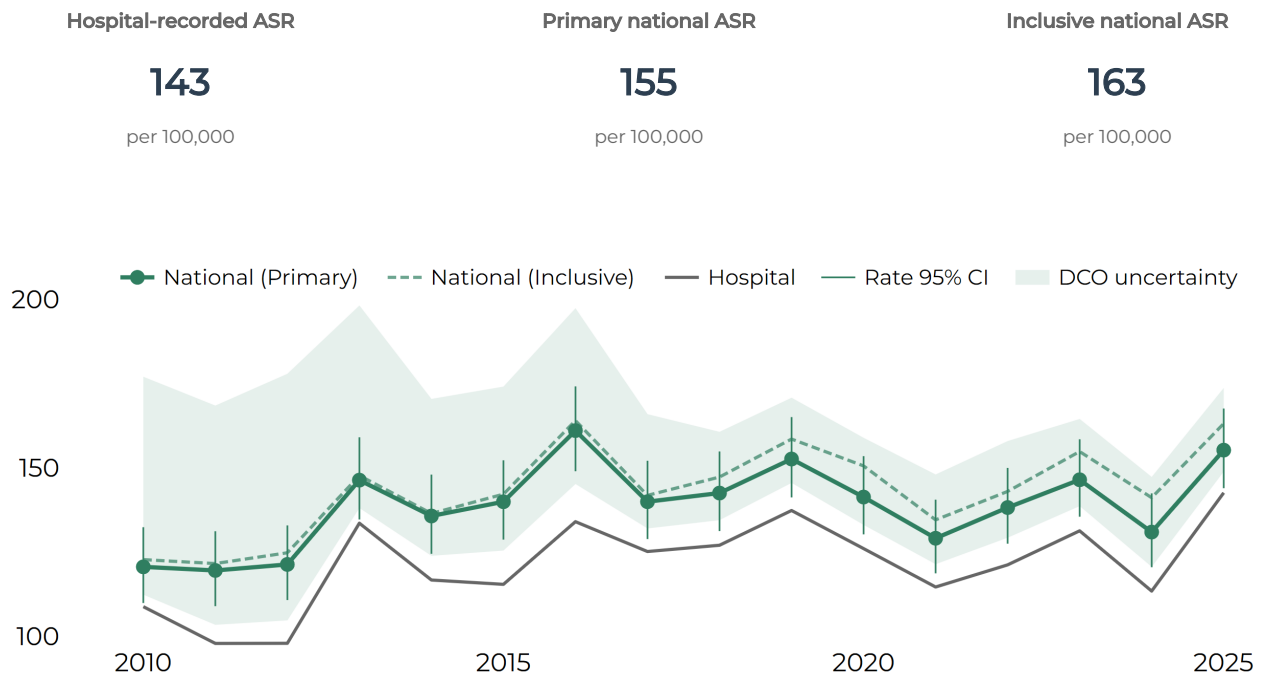


WHAT THIS MEANS

Hospital-recorded stroke events reached 693 in 2025: the highest annual count in the 2010 to 2025 series and 23% above the previous-five-year mean of 565.4. The Primary national estimate was 757.5 and the Inclusive estimate was 798.2. As Stroke is the larger event group, this increase contributed most of the overall excess in CVD events above the recent mean.

Stroke event rates

Age-standardised rates per 100,000. Whiskers are 95% statistical confidence intervals.



Latest five complete years

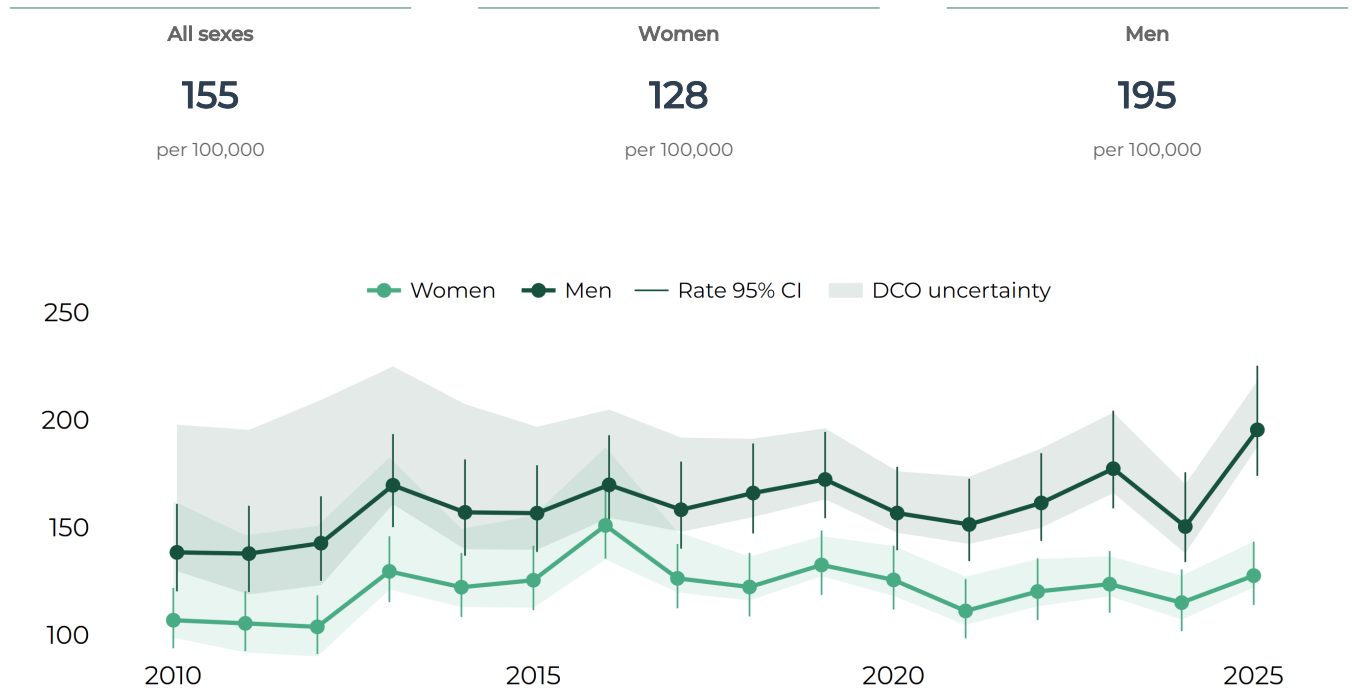
ASR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Hospital-recorded estimate	114.7	121.2	131.3	113.5	142.6
Hospital-recorded 95% CI	104.8 - 125.5	111.2 - 132.3	120.9 - 142.8	103.7 - 124.2	131.8 - 154.5
Primary national estimate	129.1	138.2	146.5	131.0	155.3
Primary national 95% CI	118.7 - 140.6	127.5 - 150.0	135.5 - 158.5	120.5 - 142.4	144.0 - 167.6
Inclusive national estimate	134.6	143.0	154.9	141.2	163.2
Inclusive national 95% CI	124.0 - 146.2	132.1 - 155.0	143.6 - 167.2	130.4 - 153.0	151.6 - 175.8

WHAT THIS MEANS

The 2025 Primary national stroke event rate was 155.1 per 100,000, up from 131.0 in 2024 and the highest point estimate since 2016. The hospital-recorded rate was 142.5 and the Inclusive national rate was 163.0. The rise is visible across all three measures, supporting the broader finding of a high CVD event rate in 2025.

Stroke events: women and men

Primary national age-standardised event rates per 100,000.



Latest five complete years

Primary ASR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
All sexes estimate	129.1	138.2	146.5	131.0	155.3
All sexes 95% CI	118.7 - 140.6	127.5 - 150.0	135.5 - 158.5	120.5 - 142.4	144.0 - 167.6
Women estimate	111.1	120.2	123.6	115.0	127.6
Women 95% CI	98.4 - 126.0	106.9 - 135.6	110.3 - 139.0	101.7 - 130.4	113.9 - 143.4
Men estimate	151.4	161.4	177.4	150.4	195.4
Men 95% CI	134.3 - 172.6	143.7 - 184.6	158.9 - 204.3	133.9 - 175.7	174.0 - 225.2

WHAT THIS MEANS

The 2025 Primary national stroke event rate was 195.4 per 100,000 in men and 127.3 in women: about 54% higher in men. Rates rose for both sexes from 2024, with a larger increase among men. The 2025 confidence intervals are clearly separated, making this an important difference to monitor and address.

2 | CVD mortality

CVD deaths

Primary = Clear + Likely CVD deaths. Inclusive = Clear + Likely + Possible CVD deaths.

Primary deaths

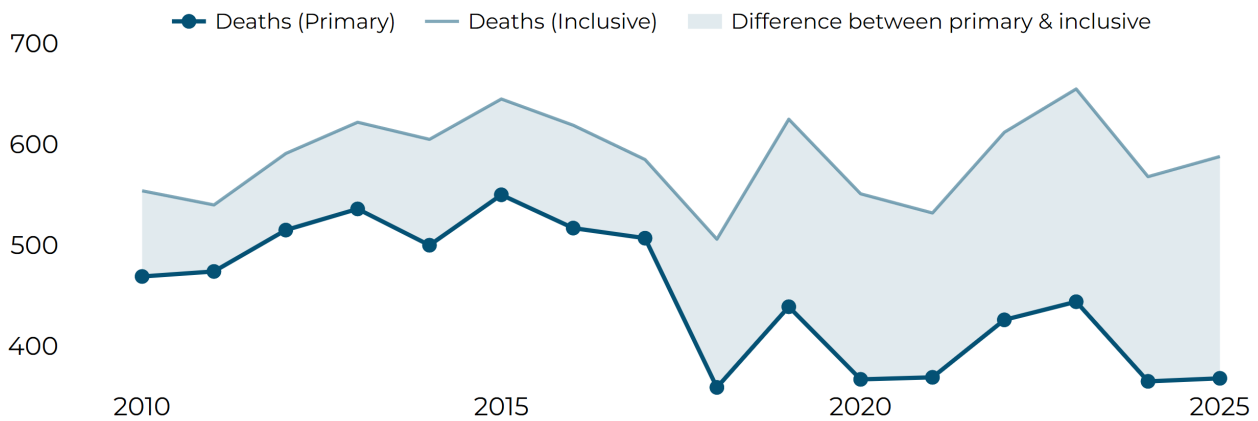
368

deaths

Inclusive deaths

588

deaths



Latest five complete years

Deaths	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Primary	369	426	444	365	368
Inclusive	532	612	655	568	588

WHAT THIS MEANS

Primary CVD deaths numbered 368 in 2025, almost unchanged from 365 in 2024 and 7% below the previous-five-year mean of 394.2. The Inclusive count was 588, up from 568 in 2024 and close to its recent mean of 583.6. The difference of 220 deaths between Primary and Inclusive measures represents the Possible CVD class included in the broader definition and shows how strongly the total depends on cause-of-death classification uncertainty.

CVD mortality rates

Primary and Inclusive age-standardised mortality rates per 100,000. Whiskers are 95% statistical confidence intervals.

Primary ASMR

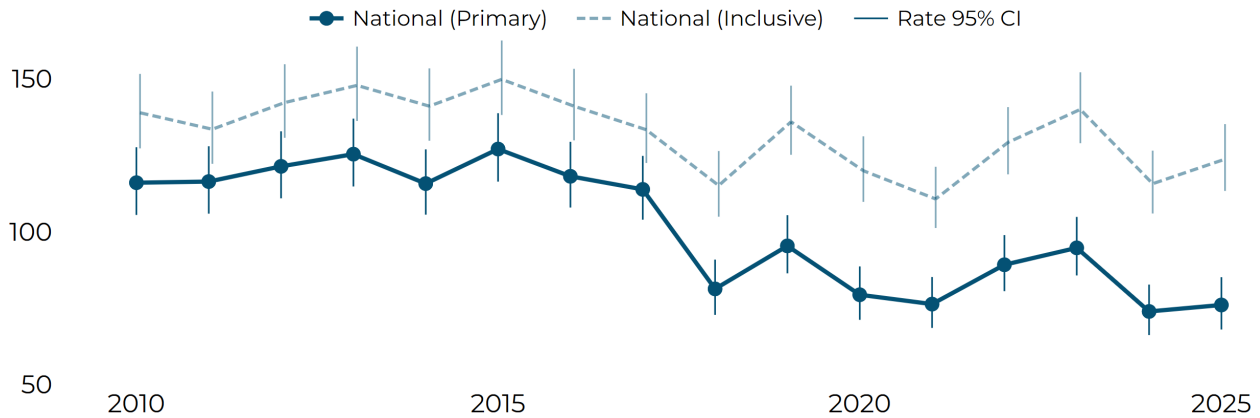
76

per 100,000

Inclusive ASMR

124

per 100,000



Latest five complete years

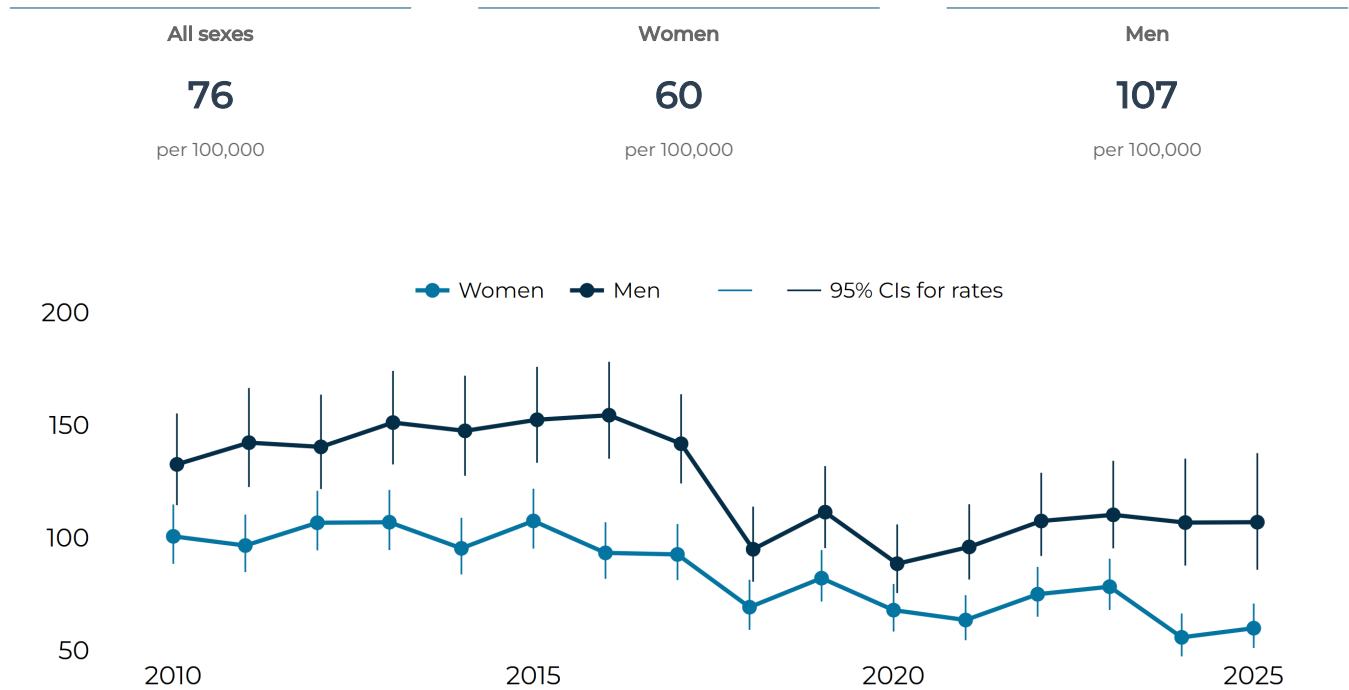
ASMR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Primary estimate	76.3	89.2	94.7	73.9	76.0
Primary 95% CI	68.5 - 85.1	80.5 - 98.9	85.7 - 104.8	66.1 - 82.7	68.0 - 85.1
Inclusive estimate	110.7	129.2	140.0	115.7	123.7
Inclusive 95% CI	101.2 - 121.2	118.7 - 140.8	129.0 - 152.1	105.9 - 126.5	113.3 - 135.2

WHAT THIS MEANS

The Primary age-standardised CVD mortality rate was broadly stable, moving from 73.9 per 100,000 in 2024 to 76.0 in 2025. The Inclusive rate changed from 115.7 to 123.7 per 100,000. The whiskers show how precise each rate is: shorter whiskers mean greater certainty, while longer whiskers mean the rate could reasonably be somewhat higher or lower. The gap between the Primary and Inclusive rates reflects the additional deaths counted when Possible CVD evidence is included.

CVD deaths: women and men

Primary age-standardised mortality rates per 100,000.



Latest five complete years

Primary ASMR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
All sexes estimate	76.3	89.2	94.7	73.9	76.0
All sexes 95% CI	68.5 - 85.1	80.5 - 98.9	85.7 - 104.8	66.1 - 82.7	68.0 - 85.1
Women estimate	63.4	74.8	78.2	55.7	59.7
Women 95% CI	54.4 - 74.4	64.8 - 87.0	67.8 - 90.6	47.2 - 66.3	50.9 - 70.7
Men estimate	95.8	107.4	110.1	106.7	106.8
Men 95% CI	81.3 - 114.8	91.8 - 128.8	95.2 - 134.1	87.5 - 135.1	85.7 - 137.5

WHAT THIS MEANS

Primary CVD death counts were identical for women and men in 2025, at 184 each. After allowing for population age, the mortality rate was 106.8 per 100,000 in men and 59.7 in women: about 79% higher in men, with clearly separated confidence intervals. Age-standardised rates therefore reveal an important difference that the equal counts alone do not show.

CVD deaths: age patterns

Primary-definition annual death counts by broad age group. These are composition counts, not age-specific rates.

All ages

368

deaths

Under 70

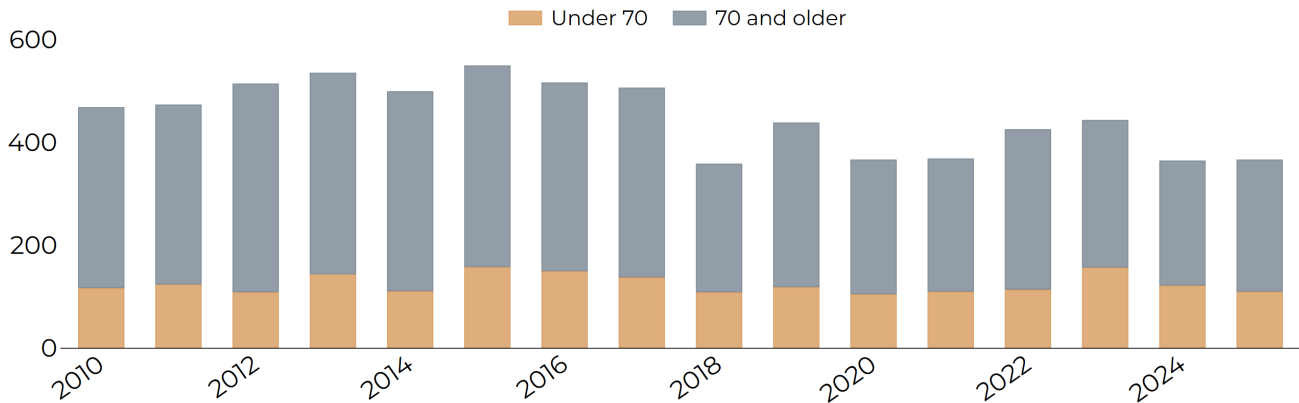
110

deaths

70 and older

257

deaths



Latest five complete years

Primary deaths	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
All ages	369	426	444	365	368
Under 70	110	114	157	122	110
70 and older	259	312	287	243	257

WHAT THIS MEANS

Of the 367 Primary CVD deaths with age recorded in 2025, 257 were among people aged 70 or older and 110 were among people under 70: 70% and 30% respectively. Both counts were below their previous-five-year means, so both age groups contributed to the lower overall total. One further Primary CVD death had no age classification and is excluded from these percentages.

Heart deaths

Primary = Clear + Likely CVD deaths. Inclusive = Clear + Likely + Possible CVD deaths.

Primary deaths

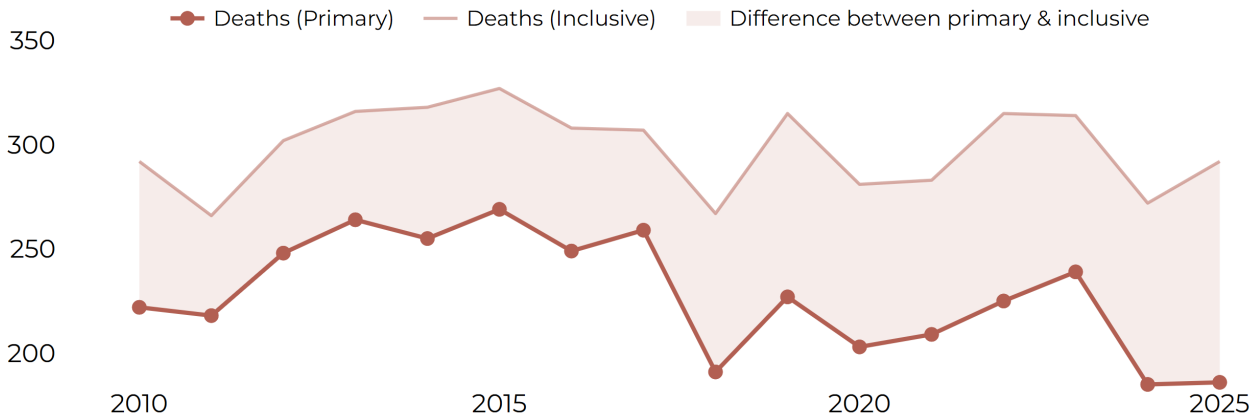
186

deaths

Inclusive deaths

292

deaths



Latest five complete years

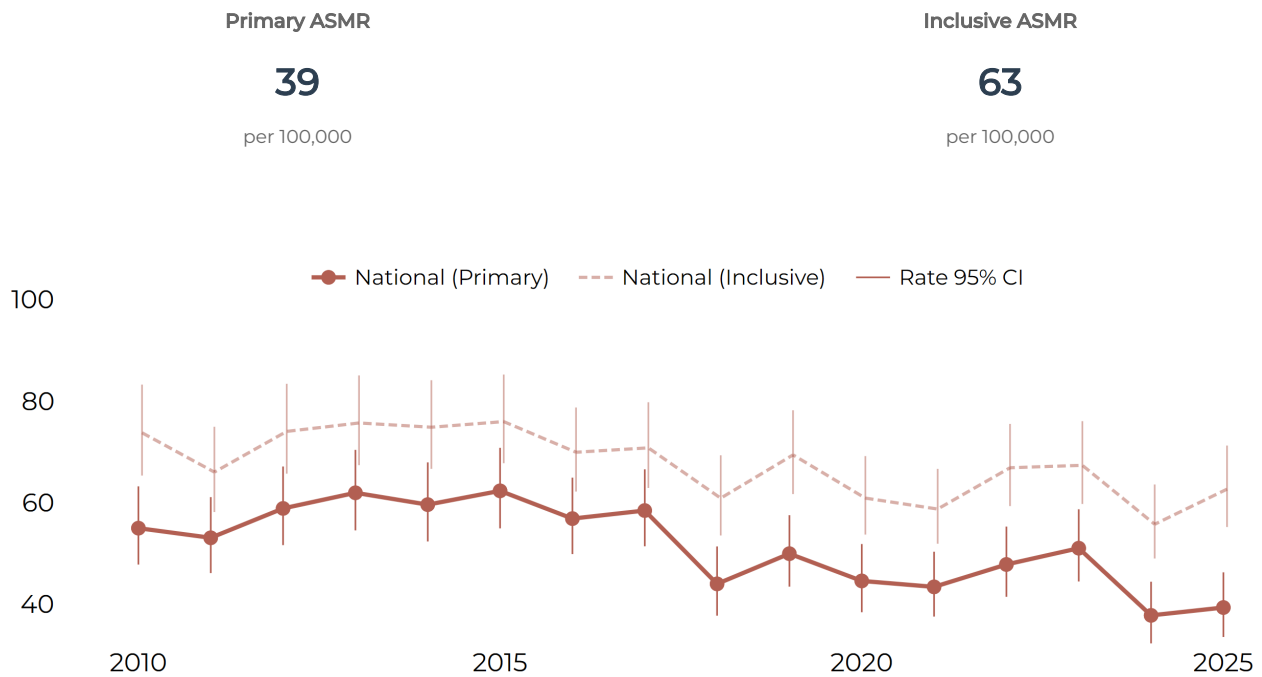
Deaths	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Primary	209	225	239	185	186
Inclusive	283	315	314	272	292

WHAT THIS MEANS

Primary heart deaths numbered 186 in 2025, almost unchanged from 185 in 2024 and 12% below the previous-five-year mean of 212.2. The Inclusive count was 292, up from 272 and almost equal to its recent mean of 293.0. The 106 deaths between the two 2025 estimates are Possible heart deaths, showing the effect of the broader classification.

Heart mortality rates

Primary and Inclusive age-standardised mortality rates per 100,000. Whiskers are 95% statistical confidence intervals.



Latest five complete years

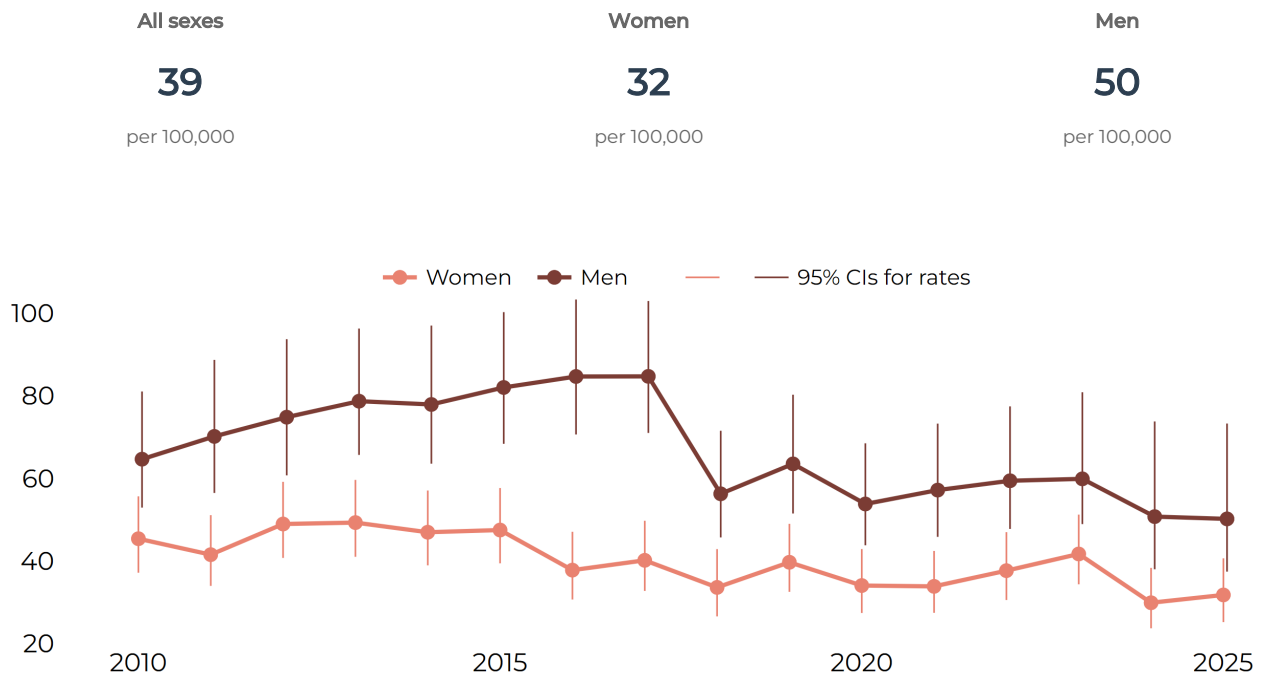
ASMR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Primary estimate	43.4	47.8	51.0	37.8	39.3
Primary 95% CI	37.5 - 50.3	41.4 - 55.3	44.4 - 58.7	32.2 - 44.4	33.5 - 46.2
Inclusive estimate	58.7	66.9	67.3	55.7	62.6
Inclusive 95% CI	51.9 - 66.6	59.3 - 75.5	59.7 - 76.0	49.0 - 63.6	55.2 - 71.2

WHAT THIS MEANS

The Primary heart mortality rate was broadly stable, moving from 37.8 per 100,000 in 2024 to 39.3 in 2025, and remained below the rates seen in 2021 to 2023. The Inclusive rate rose from 55.7 to 62.6, although its confidence intervals overlap across the two years. The distance between the lines shows the effect of including Possible heart deaths.

Heart deaths: women and men

Primary age-standardised mortality rates per 100,000.



Latest five complete years

Primary ASMR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
All sexes estimate	43.4	47.8	51.0	37.8	39.3
All sexes 95% CI	37.5 - 50.3	41.4 - 55.3	44.4 - 58.7	32.2 - 44.4	33.5 - 46.2
Women estimate	33.8	37.6	41.7	29.9	31.7
Women 95% CI	27.4 - 42.4	30.5 - 47.0	34.3 - 51.2	23.7 - 38.3	25.2 - 40.6
Men estimate	57.2	59.4	59.9	50.7	50.2
Men 95% CI	45.8 - 73.3	47.7 - 77.4	48.9 - 80.9	38.0 - 73.8	37.4 - 73.3

WHAT THIS MEANS

Primary heart death counts were similar for women and men in 2025, at 92 and 94. The age-standardised rate was higher in men, at 50.2 per 100,000 compared with 31.7 in women, as it has been throughout the series. The 2025 confidence intervals overlap slightly, so the size of the difference is estimated with some uncertainty.

Stroke deaths

Primary = Clear + Likely CVD deaths. Inclusive = Clear + Likely + Possible CVD deaths.



Latest five complete years

Deaths	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Primary	160	201	205	180	182
Inclusive	249	297	341	296	296

WHAT THIS MEANS

Primary stroke deaths numbered 182 in 2025, close to 180 in 2024 and exactly equal to the previous-five-year mean of 182.0. The Inclusive count was unchanged at 296 and was also close to its recent mean of 290.6. The stable recent pattern sits alongside substantial classification sensitivity: Possible stroke deaths make up 114 of the Inclusive total.

Stroke mortality rates

Primary and Inclusive age-standardised mortality rates per 100,000. Whiskers are 95% statistical confidence intervals.

Primary ASMR

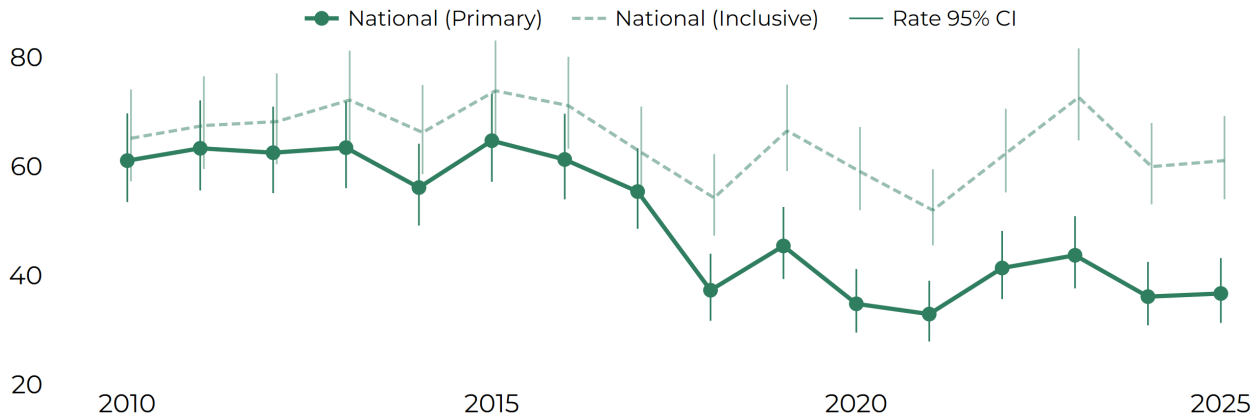
37

per 100,000

Inclusive ASMR

61

per 100,000



Latest five complete years

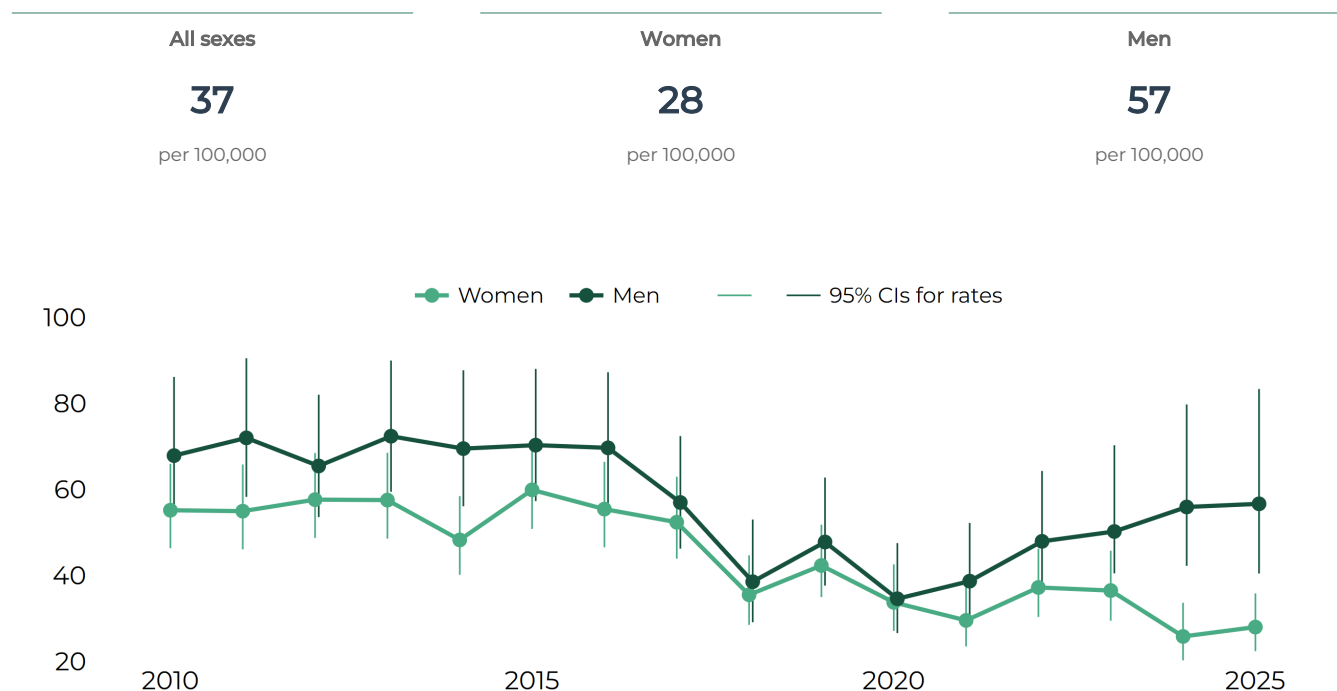
ASMR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Primary estimate	32.9	41.4	43.7	36.1	36.7
Primary 95% CI	27.9 - 39.0	35.7 - 48.2	37.6 - 50.9	30.8 - 42.5	31.3 - 43.2
Inclusive estimate	52.0	62.4	72.7	60.0	61.1
Inclusive 95% CI	45.5 - 59.5	55.2 - 70.6	64.8 - 81.7	53.1 - 68.0	54.0 - 69.3

WHAT THIS MEANS

Stroke mortality rates were broadly stable between 2024 and 2025. The Primary rate moved from 36.1 to 36.7 per 100,000, while the Inclusive rate moved from 60.0 to 61.1; both pairs of confidence intervals overlap substantially. The continuing distance between the two lines shows the effect of including Possible stroke deaths.

Stroke deaths: women and men

Primary age-standardised mortality rates per 100,000.



Latest five complete years

Primary ASMR per 100,000	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
All sexes estimate	32.9	41.4	43.7	36.1	36.7
All sexes 95% CI	27.9 - 39.0	35.7 - 48.2	37.6 - 50.9	30.8 - 42.5	31.3 - 43.2
Women estimate	29.5	37.2	36.5	25.8	28.0
Women 95% CI	23.5 - 37.8	30.3 - 46.2	29.5 - 45.7	20.2 - 33.6	22.4 - 35.8
Men estimate	38.7	47.9	50.2	55.9	56.7
Men 95% CI	30.0 - 52.2	38.1 - 64.3	40.5 - 70.3	42.2 - 79.8	40.4 - 83.4

WHAT THIS MEANS

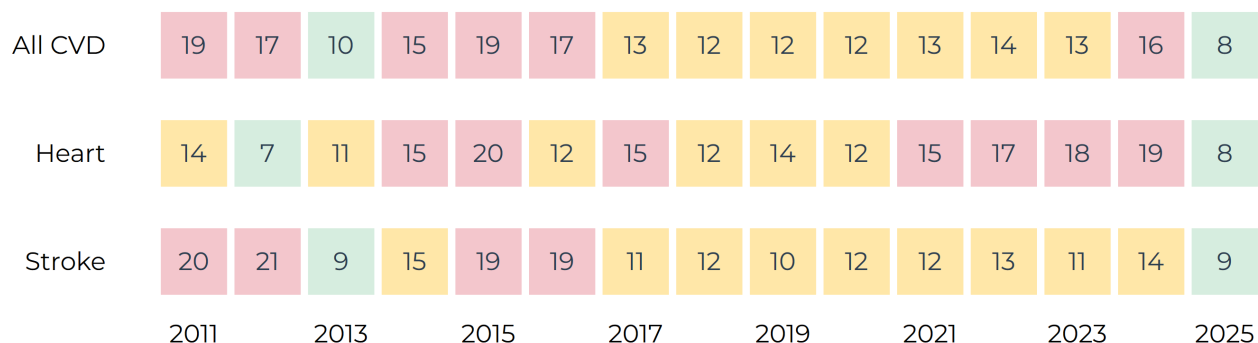
Primary stroke death counts were also similar for women and men in 2025, at 92 and 90. After allowing for population age, the mortality rate was 56.7 per 100,000 in men and 28.0 in women: about twice as high in men, with separated confidence intervals. The persistent male-female difference is important for prevention and service planning.

Sources: BNR public CVD-event release cvd_2026_06; BNR public mortality release mort_2026_06.

3 | How complete is the picture?

Events identified through death records

Each tile gives the estimated additional DCO contribution as a percentage of the Primary national event estimate. The latest 15 complete years are shown. **Green** is lower reliance, **amber** moderate and **red** higher.

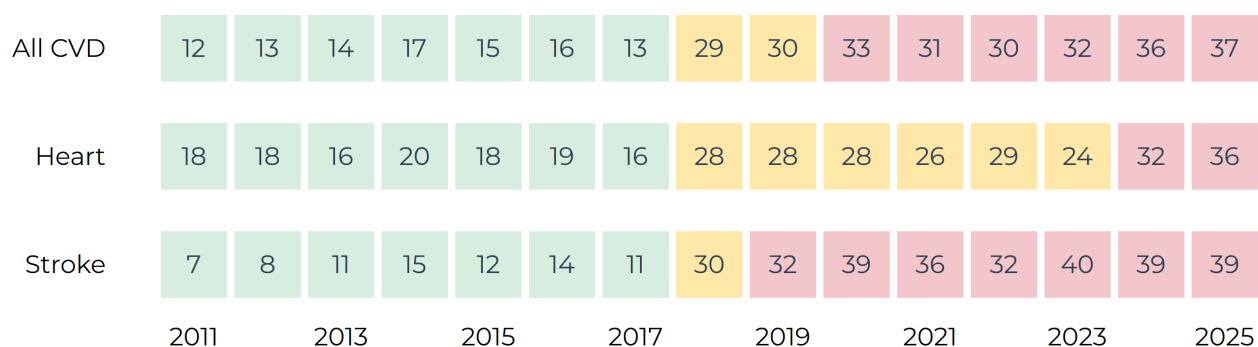


WHAT THIS MEANS

In 2025, the estimated additional DCO contribution was about 8.5% of the Primary national event estimate for All CVD, Heart and Stroke. The similarity across the three groups is useful context: death-record ascertainment contributes meaningfully to the national estimate, but it is not the dominant component of the 2025 event total.

Reliance on Possible deaths

Possible-only deaths as a percentage of the Inclusive annual mortality count. Green is lower reliance, amber moderate and red higher; the percentage remains the main information.



WHAT THIS MEANS

Possible-only deaths accounted for 37.4% of the 2025 Inclusive CVD total deaths. The corresponding proportions were also substantial for Heart and Stroke, at about 36% and 39%. These are sensitivity indicators for cause-of-death classification on death certificates. We use these sensitivity results in the absence of national underlying cause of death recording. Read more about our CVD death definitions in chapter 4|Methods.

4 | Methods

What this report measures

WHY THESE METHODS MATTER

National surveillance brings together information recorded for different purposes, at different times and in different settings. The BNR applies consistent clinical, residency, timing, linkage and quality rules so these records can support a coherent national picture. Each published result can be traced to an approved data release and is accompanied by clear information about its coverage, uncertainty and confidentiality.

Data used for this report

Series	Complete annual coverage	Public data release used
CVD events	2010 to 2025	cvd_2026_06 (2026, Jun)
CVD mortality	2010 to 2025	mort_2026_06 (2026, Jun)

Population, period and unit of analysis

This report describes eligible cardiovascular events and classified deaths among Barbados residents. Each event statistic counts eligible event episodes, so one person can contribute more than one event over time. Mortality statistics count deaths meeting the stated BNR evidence definition.

The main results cover complete calendar years from January to December. The monthly *How the year unfolded* chart provides the one within-year view. Monthly and quarterly event results describe hospital-recorded events; broader national estimates incorporating death records are completed annually.

A guide to the results

Result	What it describes	Main information source
Events	Eligible Heart and Stroke event episodes	Hospital records, extended annually with eligible death records
Deaths	Deaths meeting a stated BNR cardiovascular evidence definition	Death-certificate information
Population rates	Events or deaths in relation to the corresponding resident population	Approved releases and population estimates
Quality indicators	How much selected results depend on additional or less-certain information	Approved public-release summaries

How CVD events are identified

The BNR applies the same sequence of clinical, residency, timing and episode rules to every potential event. This turns information collected through routine care into a consistent surveillance series and supports fairer comparison over time.

COMPARING RESULTS OVER TIME

The complete series in this report can be compared consistently from 2010 onwards. The method was revised in 2025, so comparisons with earlier years should use the historical series reproduced in this report rather than estimates printed in reports from 2023 or earlier.

Heart, Stroke and All CVD

Each eligible event is assigned to Heart or Stroke under the maintained BNR rules. All CVD is the reporting aggregate formed by combining those two event groups.

Heart and Stroke event definitions

The clinical definition is the starting point. Residency, event date and episode rules then establish whether, when and how an eligible event contributes to the published series.

Reporting family	What it represents
Heart	Eligible acute myocardial infarction events, generally corresponding to ICD-10 I21-I22, confirmed under BNR clinical and validation rules.
Stroke	Eligible acute stroke events, generally corresponding to ICD-10 I60-I64, confirmed under BNR clinical and validation rules.
Decision	What the rule achieves
Disease definition	Confirms that the clinical evidence meets the approved Heart or Stroke definition.
Residence	Restricts the series to people resident in Barbados for at least six months of the relevant calendar year.
Event date	Places the event in the correct reporting period using the approved date hierarchy.
Event episode	Brings together records that describe the same clinical episode before counting.
Repeat event	Allows a later eligible event to contribute a new count when it occurs outside the 28-day event window.

Events and people

Each count represents an event episode. Records occurring within the 28-day event window are treated as part of the same episode. A later eligible event can contribute another count, so one person may contribute more than one event over time.

Hospital-recorded ascertainment

Hospital-recorded statistics use eligible events identified from hospital information. As Barbados's only tertiary hospital, the Queen Elizabeth Hospital provides an important view of serious recognised CVD events. Access to care, referral, diagnosis and recording all shape this view. The annual national reporting estimates extend it with eligible events identified through death records, as described next.

Extending the picture using death records

Some cardiovascular events are identified through death information rather than hospital records. To broaden the national picture, BNR first classifies the cardiovascular evidence on the death certificate, then matches hospital and death records so that the same event is not counted twice.

What is a DCO event?

A death-certificate-only (DCO) event is an eligible event identified from death information with no matched eligible hospital-recorded event. DCO-enhanced counts and rates are produced annually, after death-record ascertainment for the year is complete. Annual aggregation also supports safe reporting where monthly or quarterly DCO numbers may be small. Monthly and quarterly event views therefore describe hospital-recorded events.

How linkage is undertaken

Stage	What we do
1 Prepare	We prepare the hospital records and relevant death records for secure comparison.
2 Match	We compare records using approved combinations of names, dates and other identifying details, starting with the clearest matches.
3 Resolve	We accept clear matches and retain the uncertainty where the available information supports more than one interpretation.
4 Aggregate	We use the resolved links to produce anonymous aggregate event estimates for publication.

Three published views of CVD events

Published series	Information included	How to use it
Hospital-recorded	Eligible hospital events	Shows recognised serious events recorded through the hospital source. This is our conservative or lower estimate.
Primary national	Hospital events plus DCO contribution based on Clear + Likely mortality evidence	Provides the main BNR annual national estimate. This is our primary or central estimate.
Inclusive national	Hospital events plus DCO contribution that also includes Possible mortality evidence	Provides a broader estimate showing sensitivity to the wider evidence definition. This is our inclusive or upper estimate.

Record matching and death-certificate classification answer different questions. Matching determines whether a hospital record and a death record relate to the same person and event. This prevents duplicate counting and helps identify additional death-certificate-only events.

Clear, Likely, Possible, Mention only and No evidence describe the strength of cardiovascular evidence on the death certificate; they are not categories of record matching. These evidence classes are defined on the next page and are used in the Primary and Inclusive event and mortality definitions.

Linkage uncertainty range

Where unresolved links could affect the national total, the public data provide three values. The lower value uses the more conservative interpretation, the central value is the main BNR estimate, and the upper value reflects the broader contribution supported by the approved linkage rules. Because the DCO contribution is estimated at aggregate level, national event estimates may contain decimal values before rounding for presentation.

WHEN READING THE REPORT | A wider linkage range means that unresolved matching has more influence on the national estimate. Statistical confidence intervals describe the precision of a rate and answer a different question.

How CVD deaths are classified

BNR mortality surveillance uses death-certificate information to create a consistent cardiovascular classification for routine surveillance. A formally coded national underlying cause of death is not currently available to the Registry for this purpose. Because certificates are received in paper form, the BNR first transcribes them into a standard electronic format on behalf of the Government, allowing every certificate to be assessed consistently.

How the certificate is interpreted

A cardiovascular term is interpreted in the context of the full certificate before a BNR classification is assigned. We consider the wording, whether it appears in Part I or Part II, the order of conditions in Part I, relevant mortality-coding principles and the strength of the supporting evidence. Part I records the sequence leading directly to death, while Part II records other contributing conditions. These details provide the context for assigning each death to one of five evidence classes.

Evidence classes

Class	What the evidence means	Use in published definitions
Clear	Strong evidence for the relevant cardiovascular mortality group	Primary and Inclusive
Likely	Good cardiovascular evidence with some remaining uncertainty	Primary and Inclusive
Possible	Plausible cardiovascular evidence with material uncertainty	Inclusive
Mention only	Relevant wording recorded as contextual evidence	Classification recorded. Not included in estimates.
No evidence	The approved rules identify no qualifying cardiovascular evidence	Classification recorded. Not included in estimates.

Heart, Stroke and All CVD

Heart includes qualifying ischaemic and coronary heart-disease evidence, including certificates that use terms other than 'heart attack'. Stroke includes qualifying acute ischaemic stroke and non-traumatic cerebral haemorrhage patterns. Each qualifying death is resolved to Heart or Stroke under the maintained hierarchy. All CVD is the reporting aggregate formed by combining those two groups.

Primary and Inclusive definitions

Primary combines Clear and Likely evidence and is the main BNR mortality series. Inclusive contains the Primary series and additionally includes Possible cardiovascular deaths. The distance between them shows how sensitive the reported burden is to including this less-certain evidence.

Relation to official cause-of-death statistics

Official cause-of-death statistics use the full international process for selecting and coding an ICD-10 underlying cause. The BNR uses a maintained death-certificate evidence classification to provide consistent and timely cardiovascular surveillance. The two series serve related but distinct purposes, so comparisons should take their different methods into account.

WHEN READING THE REPORT | Read Primary and Inclusive as alternative views of the same mortality burden. Primary is the main series; Inclusive shows how the result changes when Possible cardiovascular deaths are included.

How this report presents CVD

The report uses four complementary ways to describe CVD burden. Each answers a different question, so the measure and its denominator should always be read together.

Measure	Question it answers	Best used for
Count	How many eligible events or classified deaths were recorded?	Describing the volume of events or deaths
Percentage	What share of a defined total belongs to a particular group?	Describing the composition of that total
Crude rate	How frequent was the outcome in the population during that year?	Describing the population's observed experience
Age-standardised rate	How do rates compare after allowing for differences in age structure?	Comparing years, sexes or populations more fairly

Counts and percentages

A count reports the number of eligible event episodes or classified deaths. A percentage shows how a stated total is distributed across groups. For example, the percentage of registered events occurring before age 70 describes the age pattern among those events; it represents a share of the event total rather than a person's chance of developing CVD.

Crude and Age-standardised rates

A crude rate relates the number of events or deaths to the resident population, usually expressed per 100,000 people. It describes the population's observed experience and is influenced by its age structure. An age-standardised rate applies age-specific rates to a common standard population, reducing the effect of differences in age structure. It is therefore better suited to comparisons across years, sexes or populations, but is a comparative measure rather than the population's actual observed rate. We consider rates again on the next page.

Why denominators matter

The denominator defines the population or total to which a result refers. Counts have no population denominator. Percentages use the eligible total named with the result. Population rates pair events or deaths with the resident population for the same year and, where relevant, the same sex and age group.

Population rates and fair comparisons

Why use a population rate?

A count describes volume. A population rate relates that count to the number of residents who could contribute to it, allowing years or groups of different sizes to be compared. Event and mortality rates in this report are presented per 100,000 residents.

Crude and age-standardised rates

Rate	What it describes	How to use it
Crude	The observed number of events or deaths in relation to the matching resident population	Describes the population's actual experience during that year
Age-standardised	The rate after applying the same standard age distribution to every year or group	Supports fairer comparison where population age structures differ

Matching the population to the result

Every event or death numerator is paired with the Barbados resident population for the same year. Rates for women and men use the corresponding sex-specific population. Age-specific rates use the population in the stated age group. The report uses United Nations World Population Prospects, 2024 edition, for the population estimates.

Age standardisation

Cardiovascular disease is strongly related to age, and the age structure of a population can change over time. Direct age standardisation applies the WHO World Standard Population 2000-2025 to every comparison. This gives each year or group the same reference age structure, allowing differences in rates to be interpreted more fairly.

TECHNICAL DETAIL | Full formulas, denominator specifications and standard-population information are provided in the online BNR Methods manual: <https://uwi-bnr.github.io/info-hub/methods/>

Understanding uncertainty and time

Every surveillance estimate contains some uncertainty. In this report, uncertainty can arise when a rate is calculated from observed numbers, when hospital and death records are linked, and when the cardiovascular evidence on a death certificate is classified. We show each separately because each answers a different question about the result.

Source of uncertainty	The question it answers	How it appears
Statistical precision	How precisely has the rate been estimated from the observed number of events or deaths?	95% confidence interval
Linkage uncertainty	How much could unresolved matching change the annual national event estimate?	Lower, central and upper linkage values
Classification sensitivity	How much does the mortality result change when Possible cardiovascular deaths are included?	Primary and Inclusive results

How to read the three forms

A narrower confidence interval indicates a more precise rate estimate. A wider linkage range shows that unresolved matching has more influence on the national event estimate. A larger difference between Primary and Inclusive mortality shows greater sensitivity to the classification of less-certain death-certificate evidence.

Statistical confidence intervals

The 95% confidence interval shows the statistical precision of a published rate. Wider intervals commonly occur when the underlying number of events or deaths is small. Crude-rate intervals use the exact Poisson (Garwood) method where specified, and directly age-standardised rates use the Fay-F Feuer gamma method.

Comparisons over time

The previous-five-year mean is the average for the five complete calendar years immediately before the year being reported. It provides recent historical context for the current result. Longer-term charts show the full internally comparable series and help readers see whether a recent change forms part of a sustained pattern.

WHEN READING THE REPORT | Read each form of uncertainty beside the estimate it describes. Together they show statistical precision, the influence of unresolved linkage and sensitivity to mortality classification.

Data quality and data confidentiality

Data quality metrics in Chapter 3

The indicators we present in Chapter 3 show how two important parts of the method contribute to the published results: extending hospital-recorded events with eligible death records (the DCOs), and including Possible cardiovascular deaths in the broader mortality definition. They make the influence of these choices visible alongside the disease estimates.

DCO contribution	The percentage of the Primary national event estimate contributed by eligible death-certificate-only events.
Possible-death reliance	The percentage of the Inclusive mortality total contributed by deaths in the Possible evidence class.

Data completeness

Where completeness is reported, it shows the proportion of eligible records containing the information required for that measure. Information that does not apply to a record is excluded from the expected total. Reading completeness alongside the results helps distinguish changes in recording from changes in CVD burden.

Protecting confidentiality

The BNR publishes aggregate totals, rates and summaries. Exact counts from 1 to 5 are suppressed, and additional values are protected where totals, calculated results or comparisons across releases could reveal a small count. An asterisk marks a protected result and means that its value remains confidential. Every proposed public release receives human review before approval.

TECHNICAL DETAIL | A data completeness report and the complete disclosure-control method is documented in the online BNR Methods manual: <https://uwi-bnr.github.io/info-hub/methods/>

Before publication

The underlying data are prepared, checked, reviewed and approved before publication. The annual report links to specific approved BNR data releases, preserving a traceable connection between the published data and every result shown here.

Responsible interpretation

Changes over time may reflect genuine shifts in population health, but they can also arise from changes in access to care, diagnosis, recording, data completeness or population estimates. Results should therefore be compared on a consistent basis: events should not be treated as numbers of people, and hospital-recorded results should be distinguished from national estimates. Each form of uncertainty should be considered alongside the estimate to which it relates. Surveillance findings can guide decisions and identify areas for closer investigation, but they do not by themselves explain why a pattern has occurred.

WHY THE RESULTS CAN BE USED WITH CONFIDENCE

These results are produced through a clear, reproducible and carefully governed process. Consistent definitions are applied across complementary data sources; uncertainty and known limitations are made explicit; every result can be traced to a named public release; and confidentiality checks and human approval precede publication. No surveillance system is free from limitation, but this approach provides a transparent and dependable evidence base for public health decisions.

Further information

Public Methods manual: <https://uwi-bnr.github.io/info-hub/methods/>

Operations manual: <https://uwi-bnr.github.io/info-hub/operations/>

Technical manual: <https://uwi-bnr.github.io/info-hub/technical/>

Special chapter | 2025

The BNR Refit

Building a faster, safer and more transparent cardiovascular reporting system

Building on a strong national resource

For many years, the Barbados National Registry has provided an important national record of cardiovascular disease. The BNR Refit strengthens that foundation by connecting case capture, analysis and public reporting through one clearly governed route. Its purpose is to provide government, hospitals, clinics and public-health partners with evidence that is more timely, reproducible and easier to understand.

The refit brings together three established software platforms, each with a clear and distinct role. REDCap supports the structured management of registry data. Maintained Stata workflows apply agreed definitions, carry out analytical checks and produce the statistics. Quarto provides the publishing framework for the BNR Information Hub, where approved results are presented through webpages, dashboards and reports. Keeping these roles separate reduces unnecessary copying and reworking, lowers the risk of inconsistencies, and makes it easier to trace every published result back to its source data, method and approval.

Three questions guided the review

We first conducted a full review of the original BNR processes. The review was shaped by three practical questions. Together, they tested whether published results could be traced to an approved source, produced consistently wherever they appear, and made available promptly without compromising confidentiality. Review findings are presented on the next page.

TRACEABILITY

Can every published result be traced to an approved data release?

CONSISTENCY

Are the same definitions and calculations used wherever a result appears?

TIMELINESS AND SAFETY

Can checked information be published quickly while protecting individuals?

Four connected areas

The subsequent BNR refit has been guided by the findings of this review. Work has been organised across four connected areas, covering the full route from managed data to public information. Each area supports the others: dependable reporting relies on sound data, consistent methods, clear governance and an effective way to share approved results.

DATA FOUNDATION

Managed REDCap data, a controlled historical data record and named source releases

ASSURANCE AND GOVERNANCE

Automated data quality checks, human approval, disclosure protection and versioned publication

DEFINITIONS AND METHODS

Consistent event, mortality, DCO, statistical and uncertainty methods

PUBLIC REPORTING

Connected dashboards, monthly updates, annual reports and one-off reports

THE REFIT PERIOD

The main refit programme runs from April 2026 to March 2027. As of 30 November 2026, core data, event, mortality and dashboard workflows are operating. Report workflows, final testing, manuals and handover continue into early 2027; later analytical modules remain future work.

What the review identified

The BNR process review followed the complete pathway from case capture through data preparation, analysis and reporting. Ten connected findings summarise the issues that shaped this BNR refit. In the table below, we use a short reference code for our 10 issues, so that every finding can be matched directly to the subsequent improvements, detailed on the next page.

Ref.	Area	What the review identified	Why it mattered
D1	Data foundation	Historical datasets, identifiers and analytical records required reconciliation	The authoritative record and the source behind a result needed to be easier to establish
D2	Data foundation	Database validation, core-variable protection, cleaning and metadata needed greater standardisation	Missing or inconsistent information could otherwise travel into later stages and delay reporting
M1	Definitions and methods	Eligibility, case-finding and event-inclusion rules had varied over time	Changing rules reduce the comparability of trends
M2	Definitions and methods	Duplicate and repeat-event controls needed consistent application	Duplicate records can inflate counts and obscure genuine repeat events
M3	Definitions and methods	Mortality and DCO evidence required a structured, reproducible classification and linkage method	National estimates and their uncertainty needed to be transparent
M4	Definitions and methods	Data preparation, analysis and report production had developed within overlapping processes	Each cycle required avoidable manual handling and was harder to reproduce
G1	Assurance and governance	Dataset sign-off, release decisions, roles and version control needed one visible route	Unclear responsibility makes approval and recovery harder to audit
G2	Assurance and governance	Quality monitoring and protection of small public figures needed to be systematic	Problems and disclosure risks should be identified before publication
R1	Public reporting	Reporting products were produced through separate, relatively slow processes	Useful information could remain unavailable after data had been collected and checked
R2	Public reporting	Methods, operating knowledge and variable definitions needed sustainable open documentation	The system should be transparent and maintainable by a small BNR team

The original audit also identified longer-term opportunities including abstraction automation, additional condition modules, research analytics, wider technical governance and periodic independent review. These remain future options and are not presented here as completed parts of the core refit.

How each finding became an improvement

The references and ordering below match the findings table on the previous page. The delivery progress is presented in greater detail on the next page.

Ref.	Issue identified	What the refit introduced	Direct benefit	Delivery progress
D1	Records required reconciliation	A reconciled historical foundation, documented lineage and named source releases	Every reporting cycle starts from an identifiable approved source	Operating by Dec 2026
D2	Data controls needed standardisation	Managed REDCap database structures, validation checks, a protected core variable set and maintained metadata	Quality issues can be found earlier, before analytical production	Operating by Dec 2026
M1	Inclusion rules varied over time	Maintained eligibility, event-definition and case-inclusion rules	Trends and products use consistent definitions	Operating by Dec 2026
M2	Duplicate controls were inconsistent	Standard duplicate checks and explicit repeat-event rules before counting	Counts are less vulnerable to duplicate representations	Operating by Dec 2026
M3	Mortality methods needed structure	Reproducible mortality classification, DCO identification, linkage and uncertainty methods	Primary and Inclusive national estimates can be interpreted transparently	Operating by Dec 2026
M4	Analytical processes overlapped	Separate, modular Stata workflows for preparation, calculation, review and publication	Fewer manual changes and a more reproducible analytical cycle	Operating; testing to Mar 2027
G1	Approval routes needed clarification	Fixed monthly data releases, full versioning, recorded human approval and controlled publication	Release decisions and recovery are visible and auditable	Operating by Dec 2026
G2	Quality and disclosure checks needed consistency	Automated quality checks, small-number suppression and whole-output disclosure review	Public information is checked and protected consistently	Operating; testing to Mar 2027
R1	Reporting was slow and separate	Approved data releases feeding dashboards, monthly updates, annual reports and one-off reports	New information reaches users without rebuilding every product independently	Dashboards operating; annual Jan and one-off Feb 2027
R2	Documentation needed strengthening	Linked Technical, Operations and public Methods manuals in open formats	Methods are transparent and the system is easier to maintain and hand over	Completion by Mar 2027

The overall redesign is structural, from the ground up. The new system replaces the repeated manual preparation of separate hard-copy reports with one controlled route from managed data to approved public information.

From approved data to public information

The refit replaces a sequence of largely separate analytical and reporting tasks with a controlled digital route. Once data have been managed, checked and approved, the same data release can supply public dashboards and linked outputs without waiting for each product to be rebuilt independently.

A controlled publication route

1 MANAGE	REDCap holds managed registry data, supported by defined checks and metadata.
2 RELEASE	A monthly named data release defines the approved source for the reporting cycle.
3 COMPUTE	Readable, modular Stata workflows create the agreed measures and outputs.
4 CHECK AND PROTECT	Automated validation checks results and withholds very small public figures; the complete output is then reviewed for disclosure risk.
5 APPROVE	An authorised reviewer confirms analytical accuracy, provides interpretation and approves readiness.
6 PUBLISH	Only approved, versioned data releases and associated publications move to the public-access Information Hub.

What digital transformation changes

FASTER

Approved information can move rapidly into connected public products.

SAFER

Disclosure protection and human review are built into publication.

CONSISTENT

Dashboards, tables and reports use the same definitions and data releases.

TRACEABLE

Each result is linked to a named data release, maintained code and documented method.

A RELIABLE HISTORICAL FOUNDATION

The 2009-2023 record was carefully reconstructed and reconciled to provide a documented, traceable historical foundation for the new system. This preserves the value of more than a decade of surveillance while making the origins and limitations of the data clearer. Some older records contain fewer identifiers for matching information across data sources than more recent records. Where this limits linkage, the resulting uncertainty is reported rather than hidden.

Special chapter | The BNR Refit

WHAT HAS CHANGED

Managed data now feed separate, controlled analytics and publication workflows.

WHAT IS OPERATING

Core event, mortality, DCO and dashboard outputs were operating by 30 November 2026.

WHAT COMES NEXT

Annual and one-off reporting, testing and manuals complete in early 2027; later analytics remain future work.

BNR REFIT — IMPLEMENTATION POSITION

Programme period: April 2026 to March 2027 · position at 30 November 2026

PROGRAMME WORKSTREAM

Programme review and data foundation

Review, historical reconstruction and architecture

CVD event identification and metrics

Identification, preparation and controlled release

CVD mortality identification and metrics

Ascertainment, classification and controlled release

DCO identification and national estimates

Death-record identification, linkage and estimation

Dashboards and linked outputs

Dashboards, standard tables and monthly updates

Annual report workflow

Candidate build, approval and publication

One-off reports workflow

Approved standalone analyses and publications

System testing and validation

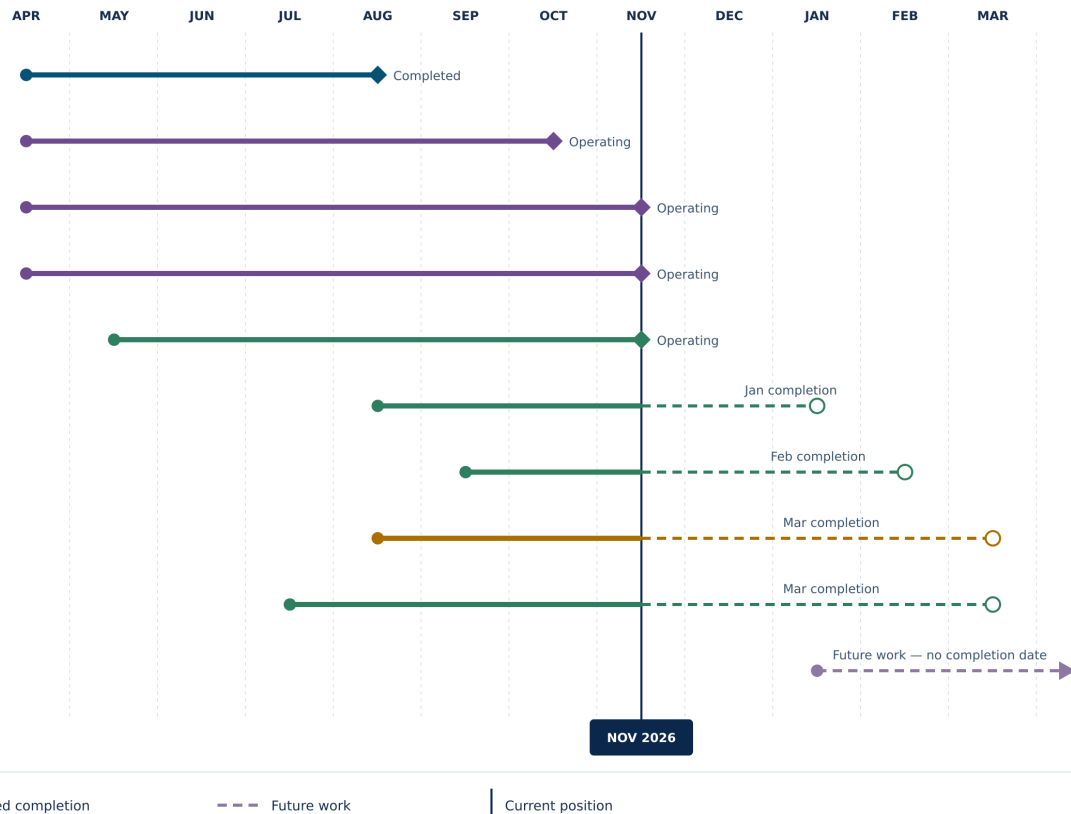
End-to-end testing and routine-use refinement

Manuals and handover

Technical, Operations and public Methods manuals

Later analytical modules

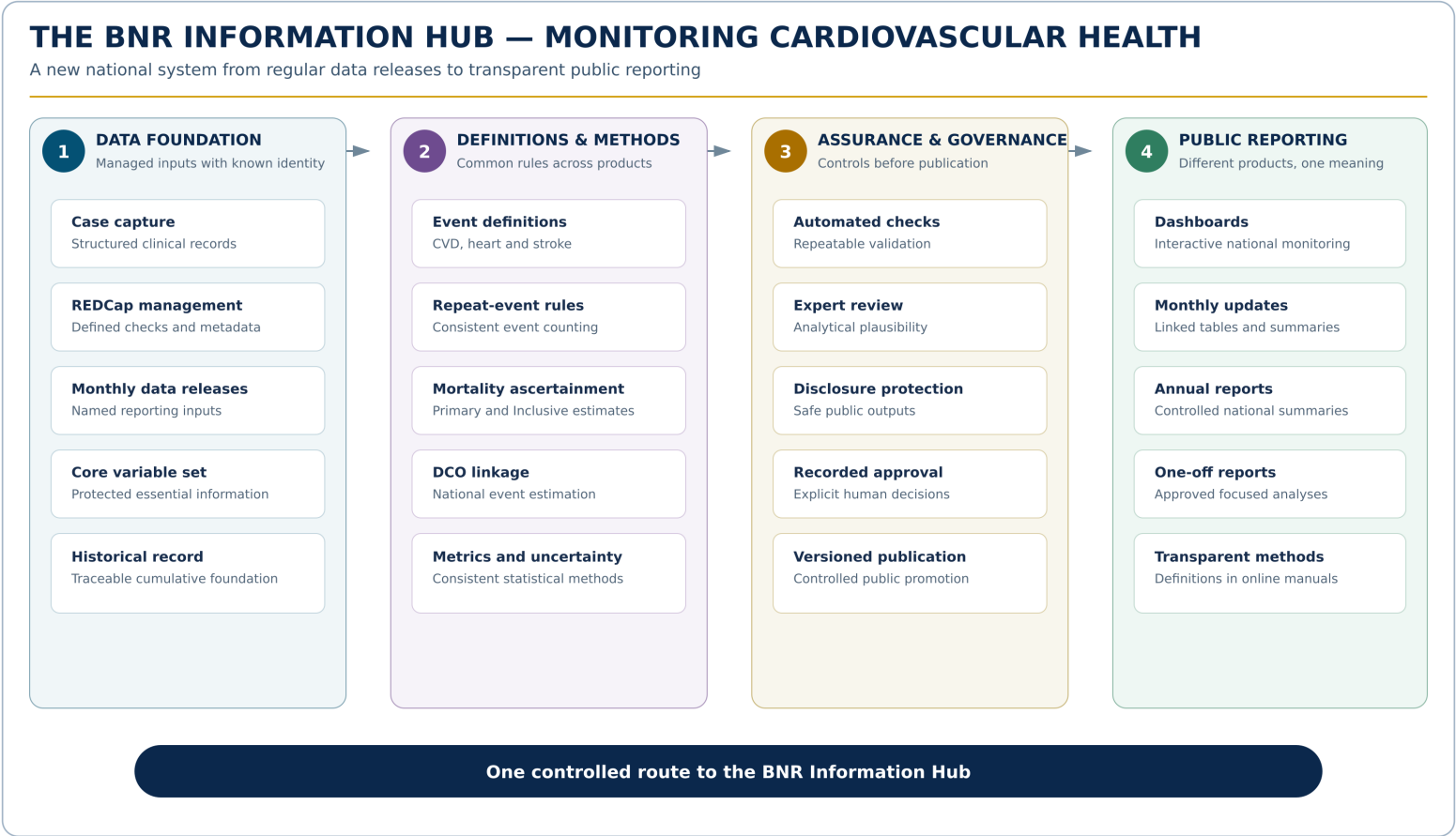
Survival and hospital-performance measures



Programme view at 30 November 2026. The annual report workflow is scheduled for January 2027 and the one-off report workflow for February 2027. Testing, manuals and handover continue to March.

Special chapter | The BNR Refit

DATA FOUNDATION	DEFINITIONS AND METHODS	ASSURANCE AND GOVERNANCE	PUBLIC REPORTING
Managed REDCap data, historical records and named monthly releases.	Event, mortality, DCO, metric and uncertainty methods.	Automated checks, human approval, disclosure protection and versioning.	Dashboards, monthly updates, reports and transparent online methods.



The four connected areas form the BNR Information Hub. Managed data use common definitions and methods, pass through explicit assurance and governance controls, and support several public products without duplicating the analytical process.

The BNR refit: current progress

The core data, event, mortality, DCO and dashboard architecture is operating. The annual and one-off report workflows will be completed in early 2027, and testing, manuals and handover continue to March. Later analytical modules remain ongoing work outside this delivery timetable.

DELIVERED AND OPERATIONAL	SCHEDULED EARLY 2027	FUTURE WORK
CVD event, mortality and DCO identification and release workflows	Annual report workflow - January 2027	Survival analysis
Dashboards with linked tables and monthly update reports	One-off report workflow - February 2027	Hospital performance measures
Controlled releases, approval and disclosure-protected publication	Testing, manuals and staff handover - March 2027	Carefully assessed new analytical modules

What this means for Barbados

- 1

Clearer and more timely evidence for government, hospitals, clinics and public-health teams
- 2

A more dependable analytical foundation with explicit dataset history
- 3

Consistent statistics across public datasets, dashboards, updates and annual reports
- 4

Transparent presentation of statistical, linkage and classification uncertainty
- 5

Repeatable disclosure protection and visible human approval before publication
- 6

A documented system designed for sustainable operation by a small BNR team

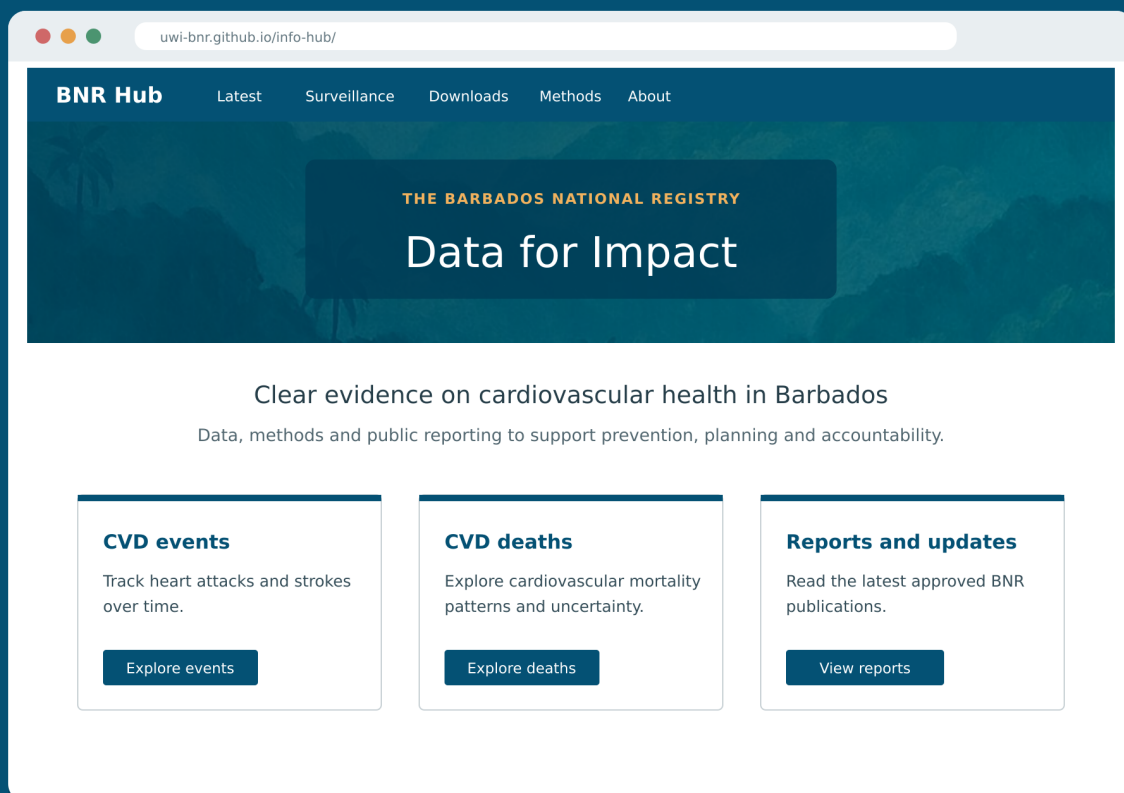
THE PRACTICAL OBJECTIVE

The same published statistic should mean the same thing wherever it is encountered - in a dataset, dashboard, monthly update, one-off report or annual report.

BARBADOS NATIONAL REGISTRY

Explore Barbados' cardiovascular evidence

Results, reports, methods and downloadable public data - together in one place.



Evidence you can find, understand and trust

View the latest evidence | Download public data | Read the methods



VISIT THE BNR INFORMATION HUB

uwi-bnr.github.io/info-hub/

Scan the code or use the address to open the Hub.

Barbados National Registry | The University of the West Indies, Cave Hill Campus

Public health update | CVD in 2025

Primary national estimates from the latest complete annual results

CVD EVENTS

1,118 events

229 per 100,000

Age-standardised | 95% CI 215-244

Heart EVENTS

359 events

74 per 100,000

Age-standardised | 95% CI 66-83

Stroke EVENTS

759 events

155 per 100,000

Age-standardised | 95% CI 144-168

CVD DEATHS

368 deaths

76 per 100,000

Age-standardised | 95% CI 68-85

Heart DEATHS

186 deaths

39 per 100,000

Age-standardised | 95% CI 34-46

Stroke DEATHS

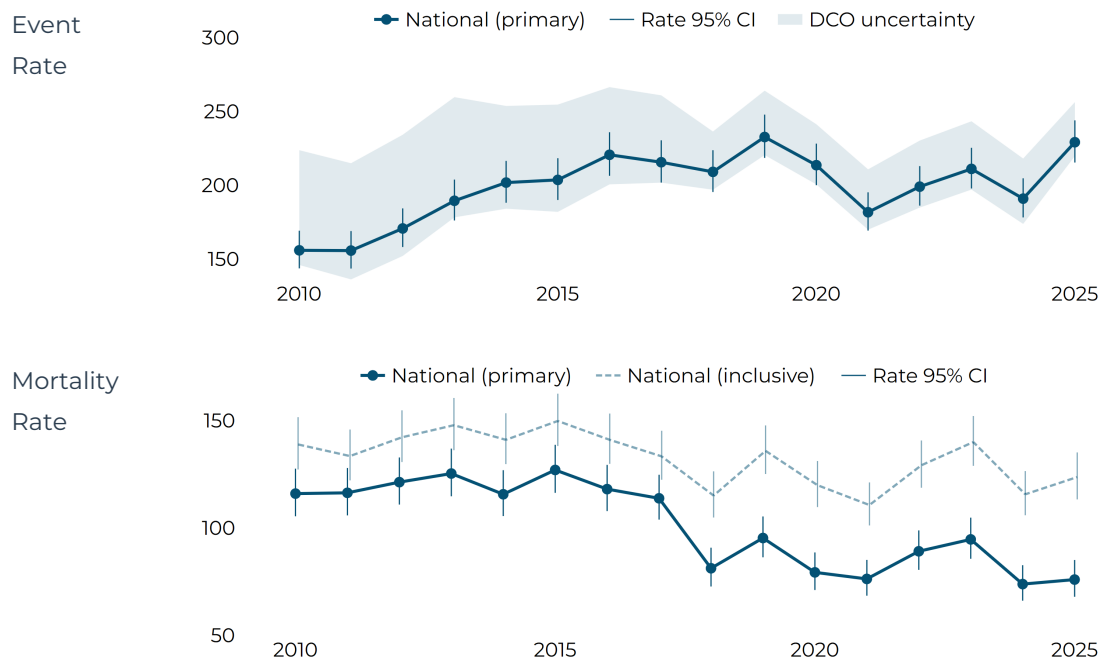
182 deaths

37 per 100,000

Age-standardised | 95% CI 31-43

National CVD event and mortality rate trends

Age-standardised national rates between 2010 and 2025. The event rate shading represents uncertainty linked to the identification of death certificate only (DCO) events. The inclusive mortality estimate includes deaths for which cardiovascular disease was a possible, but less certain, cause.



Key messages

- 01** BNR recorded 1,116 CVD events in 2025, an age-standardised rate of 229 per 100,000. The rate returned to approximately its 2019 level after several years of lower recorded rates, reinforcing the need for sustained cardiovascular prevention and service preparedness.
- 02** Stroke accounted for 758 events—around two-thirds of all CVD events—and its rate was more than twice the heart-event rate. However, heart disease and stroke contributed almost equally to CVD deaths, supporting strong prevention, acute care and rehabilitation pathways for both conditions.
- 03** CVD events returned to a high level in 2025, while the mortality rate remained near its recent low. This pattern is consistent with improved survival, although better identification of non-fatal events may also contribute. If sustained, it means more people living with CVD and greater need for rehabilitation, secondary prevention and continuing care.

Source: BNR approved CVD-event release cvd_2026_06 and mortality release mort_2026_06. Rates are age-standardised and presented per 100,000. Methods: <https://uwi-bnr.github.io/info-hub/methods/>